

How Large Language Models Answer Questions About Economic Elasticities

A repeated-elicitation study of prompt-conditioned response distributions

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This paper measures the prompt-conditioned response distributions that frontier large language models produce when directly asked about economic elasticities: under a fixed elicitation protocol, what point estimates and uncertainty distributions do the models return? The main dataset contains 10,140 successful runs across 26 models from nine organizations — 11 elicited in April 2026 and 15 in July 2026, in four waves: six frontier updates, five Chinese-lab models, the GPT-5.6 family, and a late Grok 4.5 addition — over 26 U.S.-scoped quantities (including a capital-gains convention sibling), with 15 runs per model-quantity cell, all under a single direction-first v4 prompt that embeds neutral sign-convention clarifiers for the two quantities with documented ambiguity. The headline analysis focuses on a nine-elasticity subset of the 13-quantity canonical panel, grouped into labor-and-tax and macro-and-trade subpanels; the panel’s four calibration-style parameters enter the stability and robustness checks, and simulation-facing PolicyEngine response coefficients and the capital-gains convention audit appear in separate appendix tables.

Four descriptive findings stand out. First, the model ordering is domain-specific. On the labor-and-tax subpanel, the most elastic models by average within-quantity absolute-value rank are Claude Sonnet 4.6 and Grok 4.5; on the macro-and-trade subpanel, that ordering changes sharply, with Grok 4.3 and Grok 4.20 moving to the top. Second, most labor-and-tax pooled centers fall inside rough review-based benchmark ranges, though the capital-gains realizations elasticity remains the most cross-model-dispersed object within the labor-and-tax subpanel. Third, the capital-gains convention audit — eliciting both parameterizations of the same economic object in parallel under the v4 clarifier — confirms the sign-convention story largely holds up: 25 of 26 models return a negative w.r.t.-tax-rate elasticity paired with a positive w.r.t.-net-of-tax-rate elasticity, consistent with the identity $\varepsilon_\tau = -\tau/(1 - \tau) \cdot \varepsilon_{1-\tau}$. Fourth, two exploratory cross-model cuts: models scoring higher on the PolicyBench policy-calculation benchmark elicit lower taxable-income elasticities (Spearman $\rho \approx -0.5$, raw $p \approx 0.02$, not

surviving Holm correction across the test family), and the five Chinese-lab models imply lower optimal top tax rates than the twenty-one US-lab models (medians 32.2% versus 35.9%, exact permutation $p = 0.023$, likewise not surviving family correction), with lab country confounded with serving path, completion budget, and wave. The paper’s contribution is methodological and descriptive: it offers a reproducible protocol for eliciting economic parameter distributions from LLMs and documents how those prompt-conditioned distributions vary across models and domains.

1 Introduction

Economists use elasticities constantly. They enter sufficient-statistics formulas, optimal tax calculations, quantitative macro calibrations, and applied policy debates. Yet many of the elasticities that matter most are uncertain, interpretation-sensitive, and contested. If large language models are going to be used as policy assistants, research aids, or informal synthetic experts, it matters what they say when asked for those parameters.

The key object in this paper is the prompt-conditioned elicited response distribution — what a model returns under a fixed protocol, as distinct from how well it forecasts or simulates policy behavior. I ask a model for a quantity such as the Frisch elasticity of labor supply, the elasticity of taxable income, or the Armington elasticity. I require a fixed interpretation, a point estimate, and a distributional summary. Repeating that elicitation many times lets me measure three distinct objects:

- the central estimate the model tends to report
- the uncertainty the model states within a run
- the variation the model exhibits across repeated runs

This is expert elicitation with machine respondents. It differs from LLM uncertainty elicitation on quiz-style benchmarks in its target: a contested economic quantity with no single ground-truth answer, where the disagreement itself is often part of the result.

The initial empirical question is narrow: what distributions do leading models return for a common panel of economic elasticities? The elasticity panel is useful because it includes canonical parameters with clear policy relevance and well-known disagreements in the literature. For the labor-supply and tax subset, the policy reading is straightforward: holding welfare weights fixed, lower behavioral elasticities generally imply more room for redistribution, while higher elasticities generally imply larger efficiency costs of redistribution. That monotone policy mapping holds only for the labor-and-tax subset, so the paper reports labor-and-tax results separately from macro-and-trade results.

This paper therefore contributes on three margins. First, it provides a reproducible design for eliciting probabilistic response distributions from LLMs over economic quantities. Second, it documents systematic cross-model differences in central estimates and pooled predictive

uncertainty. Third, it shows that these differences are domain-specific: models rank differently on labor-and-tax elasticities than on macro-and-trade elasticities.

2 Related Literature

This project sits at the intersection of four literatures.

First, it is closest in spirit to expert elicitation over uncertain parameters. In economics, the most directly relevant precedent is the ETI elicitation exercise in *Designing, Not Checking, for Policy Robustness* (2020), which constructs a subjective distribution over the long-run elasticity of taxable income by combining the empirical literature with a survey of economists. More generally, the decision-analysis literature on quantile-based elicitation and “Quantile-Parameterized Distributions for Expert Knowledge Elicitation” (2024) provides a natural methodological precedent for asking directly for quantiles and then fitting a distribution that preserves them.

Second, it relates to the recent literature on uncertainty elicitation from black-box LLMs. *Can LLMs Express Their Uncertainty? An Empirical Evaluation of Confidence Elicitation in LLMs* (2023) is the clearest baseline for this paper’s elicitation design because it explicitly decomposes uncertainty elicitation into prompting, sampling, and aggregation choices. *Generating with Confidence* (2023) is similarly important because it treats repeated generations as an uncertainty object in their own right, not merely alternative answers.

Third, the paper is adjacent to the growing literature on calibration and overconfidence in LLM uncertainty reports. *LLMs Are Overconfident* (2025) and *Bayesian Elicitation with LLMs* (2026) are especially close to the current design because they ask models for numerical intervals and then evaluate coverage and recalibration. Those papers target out-of-sample predictive reliability against realized truths; this paper measures the distribution a model manifests over contested economic parameters, which may admit no single clean benchmark truth.

Fourth, the paper borrows from the distribution-aggregation logic used in forecasting platforms. The closest practical analogy is *Metaculus*, whose FAQ states that for numeric and date questions the community prediction is a weighted average of individual forecaster distributions (Metaculus 2026). A community prediction differs from “model belief,” but it is a useful precedent for aggregating run-level distributions instead of averaging quantiles or endpoints directly.

Finally, review and handbook-style sources anchor the economics side of the project. For labor supply, McClelland and Mok (2012) is the key benchmark source because it synthesizes both income and wage elasticities across groups and margins. Similar review-style anchors appear throughout the registry wherever possible.

3 Design

3.1 Prompting target

The main prompt is a memory-only elicitation prompt. It instructs the model to answer from background knowledge alone — no tools, no external resources, no reconstructing a consensus estimate through a literature review. The prompt fixes the target interpretation of the quantity and requests JSON with:

- interpretation
- point_estimate
- quantiles.p05
- quantiles.p25
- quantiles.p50
- quantiles.p75
- quantiles.p95
- citations
- reasoning_summary

The run artifacts record every prompt version, and the analysis never pools materially different prompt families. The current results therefore combine a main memory-only panel with separately labeled robustness reruns when a quantity needed a targeted clarification.

Two quantities in the registry have well-documented convention ambiguity — the prime-age income elasticity (whether an increase in non-labor income raises or reduces hours is a sign, not a magnitude, question) and the capital-gains realizations elasticity (whether the elasticity is taken w.r.t. the tax rate or the net-of-tax rate flips the sign). For both of these, the v4 main prompt embeds a symmetric direction-first sign clarifier of the form “ $\varepsilon > 0$ if and only if ... / $\varepsilon < 0$ if and only if ...” that enumerates both directions without calling either typical or correct. The clarifier lists the $\varepsilon > 0$ clause first in all cases, which is itself a minor ordering-anchoring choice; a full treatment would randomize clause order across runs. The clarifier is not fully neutral — any clause ordering can carry residual anchoring — but it replaces a literature prior with an if-and-only-if definition of what the reported sign means. Other object-definition clarifications — the Armington top-nest clarification and the IES nondurable-consumption clarification — stay out of the main prompt and appear separately as appendix robustness probes because they clarify object definition, not sign.

An archived GPT-only robustness arm also allowed web search and code interpreter access on an earlier eight-quantity subset. In realized behavior, tool uptake in that arm was negligible: only 9 / 360 requests used web search, and 0 / 360 used code interpreter. I therefore treat the main design as memory-based elicitation and report the tool-access arm only in the appendix.

3.2 Quantities

The current manuscript uses a 26-quantity U.S.-scoped panel: the 9 canonical elasticities, a capital-gains convention sibling, 3 preference/macro objects, 1 TFP-persistence coefficient, and 12 simulation-facing PolicyEngine response coefficients. Headline model-comparison tables cover the canonical elasticity subpanel; the full mixed panel appears in the appendices.

The nine canonical quantities are:

- intertemporal elasticity of substitution
- extensive-margin labor supply elasticity for single mothers
- Frisch elasticity of labor supply for prime-age workers
- income elasticity of labor supply for prime-age workers
- Marshallian wage elasticity of labor supply for prime-age workers
- elasticity of substitution between capital and labor
- capital gains realizations elasticity
- elasticity of taxable income for top earners
- Armington elasticity between imported and domestic goods

The panel also includes 12 simulation-facing labor-supply response coefficients used in PolicyEngine-style microsimulation, including a global substitution elasticity override, 10 primary-earner substitution elasticities by decile, and a secondary-earner substitution elasticity. These are implementation-facing response parameters, not textbook elasticity objects, so the paper reports them in separate appendix-style tables, apart from the headline cross-model rankings.

One additional row in the current full panel, `labor_supply.policy_response.income_elasticity`, carries a legacy label. It remains in the full comparison data from the earlier full-panel run, and the headline tables exclude it in favor of the canonical income-elasticity measure.

The registry also carries a capital-gains convention sibling: `tax.capital_gains_realizations.elasticity.net_of_tax_rate` elicits the same economic object as the canonical capital-gains realizations elasticity, but defined w.r.t. the net-of-tax rate $(1 - \tau)$ instead of the tax rate τ . The two conventions are related by $\varepsilon_\tau = -\frac{\tau}{1-\tau} \varepsilon_{1-\tau}$, so a model that answers consistently across both conventions should report a negative ε_τ paired with a positive $\varepsilon_{1-\tau}$. The sibling appears only in the dedicated convention-audit appendix table, outside the nine-elasticity headline subpanels. The canonical capital-gains cell keeps the w.r.t.-tax-rate convention, matching the downstream PolicyEngine-US consumer parameter.

3.3 Repeated elicitation and pooling

I elicit each model-quantity cell 15 times. For a given run r , the prompt elicits five quantiles $q_{r,05}, q_{r,25}, q_{r,50}, q_{r,75}, q_{r,95}$. I convert those quantiles into a run-level distribution G_r using a

piecewise-uniform approximation with probability masses $(0.05, 0.20, 0.25, 0.25, 0.20, 0.05)$ on the bins:

- $[L_r, q_{r,05}]$
- $[q_{r,05}, q_{r,25}]$
- $[q_{r,25}, q_{r,50}]$
- $[q_{r,50}, q_{r,75}]$
- $[q_{r,75}, q_{r,95}]$
- $[q_{r,95}, U_r]$

where L_r and U_r are either quantity support bounds or short extrapolations from the outer quantiles when the support is not bounded. For model m and quantity k , the pooled predictive distribution is the equal-weight mixture

$$F_{mk}(x) = \frac{1}{R} \sum_{r=1}^R G_{mkr}(x),$$

with $R = 15$ in the main design. The tables report the pooled point estimate as the mean of the run-level point estimates, and the pooled 90 percent interval as $[F_{mk}^{-1}(0.05), F_{mk}^{-1}(0.95)]$.

The paper’s default interval object is the pooled predictive interval: it measures the predictive spread implied by the model’s repeated elicited answers, not the precision of their mean. The codebase implements REML and Bayesian hierarchical summaries as secondary estimators; the headline tables use the equal-weight pooled predictive mixture throughout.

The choice of $R = 15$ is pragmatic. Appendix Table A1 reports a simple prefix-stability check on the canonical 13-quantity subpanel. Relative to the full 15-run pooled summary, using only the first 10 runs in a cell changes the pooled center by a median of 0.002 and the pooled 90 percent width by a median of 0.010; using only the first 5 runs changes the pooled center by a median of 0.005 and the pooled width by a median of 0.027. Appendix Table A14 attaches Monte Carlo standard errors to the same summaries by resampling the 15 runs within each cell: the median center standard error is 0.007 at the panel median, relative width standard errors run 1 to 8 percent, and each model’s average width rank carries a narrow 90 percent resampling interval, so the predictive-uncertainty ordering is not an artifact of run-level noise at $R = 15$. None of this proves convergence, but it bounds the sampling error the headline summaries carry.

3.4 Models

The current main panel includes 26 models from nine organizations. I elicited eleven in the April 2026 rerun:

- gpt-5.4

- gpt-5.4-mini
- gpt-5.4-nano
- claude-opus-4.7
- claude-sonnet-4.6
- claude-haiku-4.5
- gemini-3.1-pro-preview
- gemini-3-flash-preview
- gemini-3.1-flash-lite-preview
- grok-4.20
- grok-4.1-fast

Fifteen more joined in July 2026 under the same v4 prompts, quantities, and repeated-run design, in four waves. Six frontier updates from the April providers:

- gpt-5.5
- claude-fable-5
- claude-opus-4.8
- claude-sonnet-5
- gemini-3.5-flash
- grok-4.3

Five models from Chinese labs, chosen because the published PolicyBench leaderboard already scores them, which extends the capability-correlates sample (see the cross-model correlates section) and adds five organizations to the panel:

- deepseek-v4-pro (DeepSeek)
- qwen-3.7-max (Alibaba)
- kimi-k2.6 (Moonshot AI)
- glm-5.2 (Zhipu AI)
- minimax-m3 (MiniMax)

And the GPT-5.6 family, released mid-extension:

- gpt-5.6-sol
- gpt-5.6-luna
- gpt-5.6-terra

A fourth July wave adds grok-4.5 (xAI), elicited on July 15 under the identical protocol after PolicyBench added it to the leaderboard — which keeps the beliefs panel a superset of the benchmark’s frontier chat models.

The design is intentionally symmetric across organizations: same quantities, same prompt family, same number of repeated runs. Each provider appears at its frontier tier as of its elicitation date; superseded models remain in the panel, which makes within-provider generation-to-generation shifts directly observable. One caution applies to such comparisons: the harness

mechanism is confounded with elicitation wave (Appendix Table A16 discloses the full per-model configuration), most sharply for Claude, whose April models ran through a forced-function-call path and whose July models ran through native structured outputs. Appendix Table A17 bounds this concern empirically by re-eliciting an April model (Claude Opus 4.7) under the July mechanism: across the nine canonical elasticities the pooled center moves by at most 0.03 (median 0.00), so mechanism effects appear negligible relative to the cross-model and cross-generation differences the paper describes.

3.5 Generation protocol and exclusions

One generation protocol covers the entire main no-tools panel.

- Models run at temperature = 1.0 where the API accepts a sampling parameter. Claude Fable 5, Claude Opus 4.8, and Claude Sonnet 5 reject sampling parameters, so their requests carry none and repeated-draw variation comes from default sampling.
- OpenAI models use Chat Completions with strict JSON-schema output and batched draws up to $n = 8$ per request for cost efficiency.
- Claude models through Opus 4.7 and all Gemini and xAI models run through LiteLLM with one request per run. Claude (through Opus 4.7) and Grok use forced function-call output; Gemini uses forced JSON-object output.
- The July 2026 Claude additions (Fable 5, Opus 4.8, Sonnet 5) run through the native Anthropic API with strict JSON-schema structured outputs and one request per run. Each keeps its provider-default reasoning configuration: always-on for Fable 5, adaptive for Sonnet 5, off for Opus 4.8.
- The five Chinese-lab models run through OpenRouter via LiteLLM in forced JSON-object mode with local schema validation, one request per run. The GPT-5.6 family runs through the same OpenAI Chat Completions path as the other GPT models.
- The nominal completion budget is 1200 tokens per run for the April panel. Models whose reasoning tokens count against the completion budget receive more headroom (4000 tokens for gemini-3.5-flash and grok-4.3; 8000 for the GPT-5.6 family, grok-4.5, and four of the Chinese-lab models; 16000 for glm-5.2, whose 8,000-token pilot returned empty responses consistent with reasoning exhaustion; 32000 for the native-path Claude models); the budget is a truncation guard, not part of the elicitation content.
- Each run is an independent request with no conversational carryover, no tool access, and no manual repair of malformed outputs.
- A run counts as successful if and only if it returns machine-parseable structured output; failed runs stay missing and drop out of the pooled summaries.
- Appendix Table A16 discloses the full per-model harness configuration — provider path, output mechanism, completion budget, sampling regime, reasoning configuration, and API identifier — in one place. Twenty-five of twenty-six identifiers are floating aliases; only claude-haiku-4.5 pins a dated snapshot. Re-elicitation at a later date may therefore hit updated model builds, and the elicitation dates above scope every result.

4 Data Collected So Far

The underlying no-tools v4 data collection contains:

- 26 models from nine organizations (11 elicited April 2026, 15 elicited July 2026 in four waves)
- 26 quantities (9 canonical elasticities plus 1 capital-gains convention sibling, 3 preference/macro objects, 1 TFP persistence, and 12 PolicyEngine simulation-facing coefficients)
- 15 runs per model-quantity cell
- 10,140 successful main-panel runs at 100% parse rate across all cells, verified by an exact-grid checker (`scripts/check_panel_grid.py`) that every cell holds exactly 15 parsed runs

Success rates are uniformly 100% under v4: every planned run for every model-quantity cell parsed cleanly into structured JSON. Under the earlier v3 panel a single model (grok-4.20) had a 12% structured-output failure rate that affected 38 runs; that failure mode did not recur in the v4 rerun. In the July 2026 extension, 58 runs (2.3% of the extension) initially failed on infrastructure errors — empty responses from gpt-5.5 exhausting its completion budget on reasoning, missing forced tool calls from grok-4.3, three claude-sonnet-5 responses exceeding a 32,000-token output cap, one transient schema-compilation error, and one safety-classifier false positive. I re-elicited those slots as fresh independent draws under the identical prompts. A per-cell manifest (`results/failure-manifest.csv`) records every replaced slot with its error class and replacement request IDs, and the re-elicitation script now archives failed records before replacing them (this archiving postdates the July round, whose audit trail is the manifest plus the retained request logs; because the July replacement happened in place, a per-slot include-versus-exclude sensitivity is not reconstructible for that round). The failures are infrastructure artifacts, not content, but two caveats keep the claim honest: truncation-type failures correlate with response length, so replacement is not provably independent of elicited values; and the two gpt-5.5 capital-gains cells failed in full at the original 1,200-token budget and reran entirely at an 8,000-token budget, a disclosed within-cell protocol change. All other affected cells replaced at most 5 of 15 runs — under identical settings for the claude-sonnet-5 and grok-4.3 slots, and at the same raised 8,000-token budget for the two partially affected gpt-5.5 cells.

The five Chinese-lab models required a longer recovery. Their OpenRouter elicitation hit an account credit ceiling partway through the first pass, and two later passes ran through local network outages that returned DNS failures; every failed slot was re-elicited as a fresh independent draw under the identical prompt, and the re-elicitation script archived all replaced records — 4,168 failure records across the five final-panel model directories (`failed-runs-archive.jsonl` per directory; the archived glm-5.2 pilot described below holds 151 more, and the later grok-4.5 addition archived 1 re-elicited slot under the same protocol) — before an exact-grid checker verified 15 parsed runs in every cell. Two disclosures from that recovery: glm-5.2 returned empty, no-JSON-content responses — consistent with reasoning exhausting its 8,000-token completion budget, the failure class the larger budget eliminated — in 109 of its

first 390 draws, so its entire main panel reran fresh under a single 16,000-token protocol (the mixed-budget first pass is retained as a pilot archive and enters no analysis), and kimi-k2.6's full 390-run main panel was re-elicited after a network-outage pass replaced its first draws — its published cell therefore comes entirely from the final pass. The failure classes are infrastructure artifacts (credit exhaustion, DNS resolution, empty reasoning-exhausted responses), not content, with the same caveat as above: truncation-type failures correlate with response length, so replacement is not provably independent of elicited values.

Tracked API cost at the model-total level for the April panel, sorted by decreasing spend:

- claude-opus-4.7: \$8.345
- claude-sonnet-4.6: \$4.277
- grok-4.20: \$3.448
- gemini-3.1-pro-preview: \$3.315
- gpt-5.4: \$1.353
- claude-haiku-4.5: \$1.203
- gpt-5.4-mini: \$0.377
- gemini-3-flash-preview: \$0.370
- gemini-3.1-flash-lite-preview: \$0.286
- gpt-5.4-nano: \$0.118
- grok-4.1-fast: \$0.058

And for the July 2026 additions:

- claude-fable-5: \$18.001
- claude-opus-4.8: \$5.860
- gpt-5.5: \$5.768
- gemini-3.5-flash: \$4.484
- claude-sonnet-5: \$2.878
- grok-4.3: \$0.751

Total tracked v4 cost: \$23.15 for the April main-panel rerun (the total excludes April clarify-probe costs for the four per-quantity-fallback models, which predate the cost-aggregation fix; see results/README.md) plus \$37.74 for the July frontier additions across their main panel and clarify probes and \$2.71 for the late grok-4.5 addition, for \$63.60 of request-log-tracked spend. The five Chinese-lab models cost \$29.25 at the OpenRouter account level, including the failed calls their recovery replaced; per-request costs for those models and for the GPT-5.6 family are untracked in the request logs and appear as em dashes in every cost column rather than as zeros. Four April premium-tier models (claude-sonnet-4.6, claude-opus-4.7, gemini-3.1-pro-preview, grok-4.20) reran quantity-by-quantity to work around a provider-side SSL hang that appeared only when a single LiteLLM client pipelined many sequential structured-output calls; the per-quantity subprocess fallback preserves request-log aggregation, so cost figures for those four models are tracked end-to-end, not extrapolated. The July additions ran through the same per-quantity path with the fixed cost aggregation. Cost dispersion across the request-log-tracked

models is large: the most expensive (claude-fable-5, whose always-on reasoning is billed as output tokens) costs roughly 310x the cheapest (grok-4.1-fast), and per-successful-run cost ranges by more than two orders of magnitude between the cheapest and most expensive tracked cells.

5 Main Descriptive Results

5.1 Rankings depend on domain, not just provider

The main descriptive result is that the model ranking changes once the quantities split into economically coherent subpanels; no single global ordering holds.

Table 1 reports the canonical labor-and-tax subpanel: Frisch, income, and Marshallian labor-supply elasticities; the extensive-margin elasticity for single mothers; the elasticity of taxable income; and the capital-gains realizations elasticity. On this subpanel, the highest-elasticity models by average within-quantity absolute-value rank are Claude Sonnet 4.6, Grok 4.5, and Grok 4.20. The lowest-elasticity models are Gemini 3.5 Flash, GPT-5.5, and MiniMax M3.

That ordering is economically interpretable, but only loosely. On this labor-and-tax subset, lower absolute elasticities imply a more redistribution-permissive reading *ceteris paribus*, while higher absolute elasticities imply larger behavioral costs of redistribution. Under that narrow reading, Gemini 3.5 Flash, GPT-5.5, and MiniMax M3 sit on the low-response side of the panel, while Claude Sonnet 4.6, Grok 4.5, and Grok 4.20 sit on the high-response side. I treat that ranking only as directional. The more meaningful policy translation is the explicit top-tax exercise below.

Table 1. Labor-and-tax canonical overview.

Note: Canonical labor-and-tax subpanel only: 6 quantities x 26 models x 15 runs. Average ranks are computed within quantity using the absolute value of the pooled point estimate.

Model	Organiza- tion	Avg abs- elasticity rank (1=high- est)	Avg predictive- uncertainty rank (1=nar- rowest)	Mean absolute pooled center	Mean pooled 90% width	Success rate	Cost / successful run
Claude Sonnet 4.6	An- thropic	7.08	13	0.428	0.978	100.0%	\$0.0112
Grok 4.5	xAI	8.42	13.83	0.387	1.049	100.0%	\$0.0066
Grok 4.20	xAI	8.5	19.67	0.362	1.245	100.0%	\$0.0092

Model	Organization	Avg abs-elasticity rank (1=high-est)	Avg predictive-uncertainty rank (1=narrowest)	Mean absolute pooled center	Mean pooled 90% width	Success rate	Cost / successful run
Qwen 3.7 Max	Alibaba	9	19.83	0.429	1.262	100.0%	—
GPT-5.6 Terra	OpenAI	10.17	14.33	0.361	1.02	100.0%	—
GLM-5.2	Zhipu AI	10.75	17.33	0.37	1.406	100.0%	—
Grok 4.3	xAI	11.08	14.33	0.37	1.125	100.0%	\$0.0018
Claude Haiku 4.5	Anthropic	11.5	9.67	0.369	0.911	100.0%	\$0.0031
Gemini 3 Flash	Google	12.5	8.5	0.382	0.892	100.0%	\$0.0009
GPT-5.4	OpenAI	13	13.5	0.411	1.243	100.0%	\$0.0036
Claude Fable 5	Anthropic	13.25	5.17	0.376	0.812	100.0%	\$0.0403
GPT-5.4 mini	OpenAI	13.25	20.67	0.406	1.452	100.0%	\$0.0010
Claude Opus 4.7	Anthropic	13.5	8	0.394	0.93	100.0%	\$0.0221
Claude Opus 4.8	Anthropic	13.67	8.5	0.391	0.902	100.0%	\$0.0146
GPT-5.4 nano	OpenAI	13.83	16.33	0.313	1.086	100.0%	\$0.0003
Kimi K2.6	Moonshot AI	14.25	17.17	0.324	1.205	100.0%	—
DeepSeek V4 Pro	DeepSeek	14.33	17	0.312	1.158	100.0%	—
Gemini 3.1 Pro	Google	14.83	6.5	0.371	0.79	100.0%	\$0.0091
GPT-5.6 Sol	OpenAI	15.08	10.33	0.339	0.938	100.0%	—
Grok 4.1 Fast	xAI	15.17	21.83	0.327	1.422	100.0%	\$0.0002
Claude Sonnet 5	Anthropic	15.5	7.17	0.367	0.893	100.0%	\$0.0068
Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite	Google	15.75	9.5	0.367	1.022	100.0%	\$0.0007

Model	Organization	Avg abs-elasticity rank (1=high-est)	Avg predictive-uncertainty rank (1=narrowest)	Mean absolute pooled center	Mean pooled 90% width	Success rate	Cost / successful run
GPT-5.6 Luna	OpenAI	17.25	22.5	0.318	1.554	100.0%	—
MiniMax M3	MiniMax	17.5	19	0.3	1.154	100.0%	—
GPT-5.5	OpenAI	19.5	7.33	0.328	0.917	100.0%	\$0.0159
Gemini 3.5 Flash	Google	22.33	10	0.218	1.059	100.0%	\$0.0126

Table 2 reports the macro-and-trade subpanel: the intertemporal elasticity of substitution, the capital-labor substitution elasticity, and the Armington elasticity. Here the ordering changes sharply. Grok 4.3, Grok 4.20, and GPT-5.6 Luna move to the top of the ranking, while Claude Opus 4.7 and Claude Haiku 4.5 move to the bottom. The key point is that the ordering is domain-specific; no family is uniformly “more elastic.”

The pooled predictive-uncertainty ranking also changes across subpanels. In labor-and-tax, Claude Fable 5, Gemini 3.1 Pro, and Claude Sonnet 5 are the tightest models, whereas GPT-5.6 Luna, Grok 4.1 Fast, and GPT-5.4 mini are the widest. In macro-and-trade, Claude Haiku 4.5 becomes the tightest model, while GPT-5.6 Luna, Grok 4.20, and Grok 4.3 are the widest. This is pooled predictive uncertainty, not calibrated confidence.

The macro-and-trade subpanel contains only three quantities, so the ranking is easily overturned by a single object. The leave-one-organization-out robustness (Appendix Table A3) shows Spearman ρ stays above 0.99 even on this subpanel, but read the ranking as directional, not fine-grained. The Armington clarification evidence (Appendix Table A7) reinforces that this subpanel’s ordering is particularly sensitive to object definition.

Table 2. Macro-and-trade canonical overview.

Note: Canonical macro-and-trade subpanel only: 3 quantities x 26 models x 15 runs. Average ranks are computed within quantity using the absolute value of the pooled point estimate.

Model	Organization	Avg abs-elasticity rank (1=high-est)	Avg predictive-uncertainty rank (1=narrowest)	Mean absolute pooled center	Mean pooled 90% width	Success rate	Cost / successful run
Grok 4.3	xAI	5.5	22	1.509	3.887	100.0%	\$0.0018
Grok 4.20	xAI	6.17	23.67	1.257	3.986	100.0%	\$0.0089
GPT-5.6 Luna	OpenAI	6.5	24	1.291	4.144	100.0%	—
GPT-5.4 nano	OpenAI	6.67	15.33	1.256	2.696	100.0%	\$0.0003
GPT-5.4 mini	OpenAI	6.67	20.5	1.241	3.491	100.0%	\$0.0009
GPT-5.4	OpenAI	8.5	8	1.267	2.393	100.0%	\$0.0033
Grok 4.5	xAI	9.33	20.67	1.344	3.446	100.0%	\$0.0065
Gemini 3.5 Flash	Google	9.5	12.33	1.153	2.473	100.0%	\$0.0104
Kimi K2.6	Moon-shot AI	10.67	21.67	1.11	3.23	100.0%	—
Gemini 3.1 Pro	Google	12	12.33	1.27	2.506	100.0%	\$0.0091
GPT-5.6 Sol	OpenAI	12	15.67	1.107	2.904	100.0%	—
GLM-5.2	Zhipu AI	12	16.67	1.102	3	100.0%	—
Claude Sonnet 4.6	Anthropic	12.67	11.83	1.16	2.724	100.0%	\$0.0109
GPT-5.5	OpenAI	13.83	14.33	1.121	2.918	100.0%	\$0.0101
Claude Sonnet 5	Anthropic	14.17	9.33	1.433	2.948	100.0%	\$0.0064
Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite	Google	15.83	10	1.164	2.943	100.0%	\$0.0007
GPT-5.6 Terra	OpenAI	16.67	6.67	1.056	2.03	100.0%	—
Claude Opus 4.8	Anthropic	16.67	8.83	1.167	2.737	100.0%	\$0.0137
Grok 4.1 Fast	xAI	17.33	10.83	0.907	1.785	100.0%	\$0.0001

Model	Organization	Avg abs-elasticity rank (1=high-est)	Avg predictive-uncertainty rank (1=narrowest)	Mean absolute pooled center	Mean pooled 90% width	Success rate	Cost / successful run
DeepSeek V4 Pro	DeepSeek	18	17.67	0.999	2.79	100.0%	—
Claude Fable 5	Anthropic	18.33	7	1.041	2.127	100.0%	\$0.0397
Gemini 3 Flash	Google	18.83	11.33	0.94	2.632	100.0%	\$0.0009
MiniMax M3	MiniMax	20	8.67	1.038	2.217	100.0%	—
Qwen 3.7 Max	Alibaba	20.33	11.33	0.884	2.269	100.0%	—
Claude Haiku 4.5	Anthropic	20.5	2	0.881	1.389	100.0%	\$0.0031
Claude Opus 4.7	Anthropic	22.33	8.33	0.878	2.224	100.0%	\$0.0211

5.2 Most labor-and-tax centers lie inside rough review ranges

Table 3 compares the labor-and-tax pooled centers to rough review-based benchmark intervals. These are hand-coded literature anchors — not benchmark truths — that check whether the elicited centers live in the right neighborhood.

For most labor-and-tax quantities, the answer is yes. Every one of the 26 models falls inside the rough benchmark range for the Frisch elasticity. 25 / 26 lie inside for capital gains realizations, the uncompensated wage elasticity, and the extensive-margin single-mother elasticity, and 22 / 26 for the canonical income elasticity. The sign-convention clarifier in v4 eliminated the clear wrong-sign centers that appeared in the earlier v3 panel, though one April model still sits at an economically null income elasticity (gpt-5.4-nano at -0.001). One July addition reintroduces sign instability in a sharper form: gemini-3.5-flash is bimodal on both sign-sensitive quantities, not centered near zero. On capital gains realizations, 10 of its 15 runs are negative (between -0.7 and -0.2) and 5 are large and positive (between +0.4 and +1.3), so the mean center of +0.010 is sign cancellation across modes (the run-level median is -0.40); on the income elasticity, 11 runs are mildly negative and 4 are positive, again yielding a near-zero mean (+0.011) that no individual run states. Nine of the fifteen capital-gains runs and five of the fifteen income-elasticity runs also required quantile repair, concentrated in exactly these cells. The clarifier therefore reduces but does not eliminate sign instability in new model generations, and

a near-zero mean on a sign-sensitive quantity reads as a symptom of mode-mixing, not a stated belief. gpt-5.5 also centers just above the income-elasticity band at -0.035. ETI remains a quantity with upper-edge pressure: 23 / 26 models fall inside the rough range, with three models just above the review band’s upper anchor of 0.5: the same two April models (claude-haiku-4.5 at 0.507, gpt-5.4-nano at 0.552) and qwen-3.7-max at 0.554, the panel maximum. The band itself sits in the upper half of the Saez, Slemrod, and Giertz (2012) survey range of 0.12 to 0.40, extended to 0.5 to reflect higher top-earner estimates (Gruber and Saez 2002); several models (Claude Sonnet 4.6 at 0.500, Grok 4.20 at 0.500, and now Claude Sonnet 5 at 0.473) concentrate at or near that upper anchor. That even the benchmark-consistent models lean toward the top of the review range is itself a finding about the models’ elicited ETI distributions.

This benchmark table is useful because it distinguishes two kinds of disagreement. On many quantities, the models disagree with each other but still sit inside a conventional literature neighborhood. On a few quantities, the disagreement includes benchmark outliers. Appendix Table A6 sharpens the same point from a different angle: on every canonical quantity, cross-model spread in pooled centers remains smaller than the average pooled 90 percent width. Within the labor-and-tax subpanel the largest spread-to-width ratio occurs for the capital gains realizations elasticity (0.52); across the full canonical panel, TFP persistence (0.65) and the intertemporal elasticity of substitution (0.55) rank higher still.

Table 3. Rough literature comparison for the labor-and-tax subpanel.

Note: Rough review-based benchmark intervals for the canonical labor-and-tax subpanel. These intervals are hand-coded literature anchors rather than benchmark truths.

Quantity	Rough review range	Models in range	Model min center	Model max center	Benchmark sources
Capital gains realizations elasticity	[-1, -0.2]	25 / 26	-0.93	0.01	Dowd, McClelland, and Muthitacharoen 2015; Burman and Randolph 1994; CBO/JCT medium-run convention

Quantity	Rough review range	Models in range	Model min center	Model max center	Benchmark sources
Elasticity of taxable income	[0.25, 0.5]	23 / 26	0.35	0.554	Gruber and Saez 2002 (high-income estimates); Saez, Slemrod, and Giertz 2012 (survey range 0.12-0.40, upper half)
Employment participation elasticity of single mothers	[0.3, 1]	25 / 26	0.213	0.717	Chetty, Guren, Manoli, and Weber 2013 (elasticity implied by Eissa and Liebman 1996); Meyer and Rosenbaum 2001
Frisch elasticity of labor supply	[0.25, 0.75]	26 / 26	0.283	0.593	CBO 2012; Peterman 2016; lifecycle and macro-calibration literature

Quantity	Rough review range	Models in range	Model min center	Model max center	Benchmark sources
Income elasticity of labor supply	[-0.15, -0.05]	22 / 26	-0.107	0.011	CBO 2012; Blundell and MaCurdy 1999; Imbens, Rubin, and Sacerdote 2001 (marginal propensity to earn, converted to an elasticity)
Uncompen- sated wage elasticity of labor supply	[0.05, 0.3]	25 / 26	0.04	0.168	CBO 2012; Blundell and MaCurdy 1999

5.3 A utilitarian sufficient-statistics top-tax exercise

The labor-and-tax subpanel also permits one concrete policy translation. For the elasticity of taxable income, I map each model’s pooled ETI distribution into an optimal top marginal tax rate using the standard sufficient-statistics formula in the top bracket ([Saez 2001](#)):

$$\tau^* = \frac{1 - \bar{g}}{1 - \bar{g} + ae},$$

with a Pareto parameter estimated from the weighted top 1 percent tail of tax-unit adjusted gross income in PolicyEngine’s certified microdata ([PolicyEngine Team 2024](#)).¹ In the current build, that estimate is $a = 1.621$. For the headline column I assume log utility over consumption, $u(c) = \log c$, and weight top-bracket earners by their average marginal utility normalized to the marginal utility of the earner at the top-bracket threshold. Under a Pareto(a) tail and CRRA(γ) utility that threshold-normalized weight is

¹The weighted top-1-percent AGI threshold is \$725,533 in the current build (with a tail mean of \$1,894,129). This is the top-1-percent tax-unit cutoff in the microdata, not the statutory top-bracket edge, which is \$640,600 for single filers and \$768,700 for married-filing-jointly under TCJA-extended / OBBBA parameters in 2026. Robustness to threshold choice maps onto robustness to the Pareto parameter a ; see Appendix Table A13. The exercise binds to no particular statutory bracket — the ETI-based top-rate formula is a common public-finance object that compares across models regardless of where the “top” is drawn. When the microdata calibration is unavailable, the build falls back to $a = 1.5$ and prints a warning; every number in this section comes from the microdata build committed with the paper.

$$\bar{g} = \frac{a}{a + \gamma} = \frac{1.621}{2.621} \approx 0.618,$$

so the headline mapping becomes

$$\tau^* = \frac{0.382}{0.382 + 1.621e}.$$

Two caveats on the welfare weight. First, it is a normalization choice, not an implication of the elicited data: the standard population-normalized utilitarian benchmark drives the top weight toward zero as top incomes grow far beyond the population mean, collapsing the formula to the revenue-maximizing (Diamond-Saez) rate $\tau^* = 1/(1 + ae)$ (Diamond 1998; Saez 2001). Table 4 reports that $\bar{g} \rightarrow 0$ benchmark alongside the headline column; at the elicited ETI medians it runs from 52.6% to 63.8%, so the threshold normalization reduces the level of the headline rates — though not the cross-model ordering — by roughly 40 percent. Second, calling the headline column “utilitarian” without qualification would overstate it; it is a utilitarian mapping under a specific, disclosed normalization.

The exercise is intentionally stylized. It uses only the ETI — the rest of the labor-supply block stays out — and the microdata enter only through the top-tail calibration, not a full reform simulation. In exchange, it yields a common public-finance object comparable across models. For this policy mapping, I truncate ETI below at zero so the standard sufficient-statistics interpretation remains well defined. Every model’s pooled ETI p05 exceeds 0.10 in Table 4, so the truncation affects negligible mass in practice.

Appendix Table A12 shows why this benchmark beats a static flat-tax-plus-demogrant microsimulation for this purpose: absent behavioral responses or leisure in the objective, that exercise describes a distributional frontier, not a meaningful optimal-tax calculation.

The richer point is the propagated uncertainty, beyond the spread in medians. (Table 4 keys off pooled mixture medians, which differ slightly from the mean centers quoted elsewhere in the text — for example, Claude Haiku 4.5’s ETI median of 0.502 versus its mean center of 0.507.) Under this threshold-normalized log-utility mapping with a microdata-calibrated Pareto tail, the implied optimal top-rate median ranges from 29.8% for Qwen 3.7 Max to 40.2% for Gemini 3.1 Pro, with GPT-5.4 at 35.9%. That is a 10.4 percentage-point cross-model spread in medians. But the within-model uncertainty bands are much wider: top-rate 90 percent intervals are roughly 42 to 52 percentage points wide across models, partly because several models place non-trivial elicited mass on top-earner ETIs above 1, well beyond the empirical literature. The exercise cuts both ways: elicited ETI differences map into meaningfully different central policy conclusions, and any single model’s implied optimal-tax recommendation remains very noisy under the paper’s own uncertainty object.

Appendix Table A13 reports the same median mapping under alternative values of the Pareto tail parameter a and the CRRA curvature γ . Moving a from the baseline 1.621 to 1.3 shifts

every model’s implied top rate up by 7.8 to 8.6 percentage points, and moving a to 1.7 shifts every model down by 1.6 to 1.9 percentage points — the cross-model ordering is invariant under these shifts. Replacing log utility with CRRA at $\gamma = 2$ (holding a at the baseline) lowers the threshold-normalized welfare weight from $\bar{g} = 0.618$ to $\bar{g} = 0.448$ and raises every model’s top rate by 8.2 to 9.1 percentage points, again without re-ordering the models.

Table 4. Optimal top-tax exercise from ETI distributions.

Note: Toy public-finance mapping from each model’s pooled ETI distribution to an optimal top marginal tax rate under the Saez top-bracket formula $\tau^* = (1 - \bar{g}) / (1 - \bar{g} + a e)$, with a Pareto parameter $a = 1.621$ estimated from the weighted top 1% tax-unit AGI tail in PolicyEngine’s certified microdata (threshold \$725,533, tail mean \$1,894,129). The welfare weight $\bar{g} = a / (a + \gamma) = 0.618$ is the average marginal utility of top-bracket earners under CRRA ($\gamma = 1$) utility and a Pareto(a) income tail, normalized to the marginal utility of the earner at the top-bracket threshold. It is a threshold-normalized weight, not the population-normalized utilitarian weight, which would drive $\bar{g}$ toward zero; the Revenue-max column reports that $\bar{g} \rightarrow 0$ (Diamond-Saez revenue-maximizing) benchmark $\tau^* = 1 / (1 + a e)$ at the ETI median. ETI is truncated below at zero for this policy mapping.

Model	ETI median [90%]	Top rate median [90%]	Revenue-max median	Top-rate 90% width (pp)
Gemini 3.1 Pro	0.351 [0.103, 0.868]	40.2% [21.3%, 69.5%]	63.8%	48.2
Gemini 3.5 Flash	0.357 [0.102, 0.832]	39.8% [22.0%, 69.8%]	63.4%	47.7
GPT-5.5	0.369 [0.122, 0.994]	39.0% [19.1%, 65.9%]	62.6%	46.8
GPT-5.6 Luna	0.377 [0.068, 1.202]	38.4% [16.4%, 77.5%]	62.0%	61.1
Claude Opus 4.8	0.383 [0.105, 0.993]	38.0% [19.2%, 69.1%]	61.7%	49.9
Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite	0.389 [0.101, 0.951]	37.7% [19.8%, 69.9%]	61.3%	50.1
Claude Opus 4.7	0.400 [0.123, 0.993]	37.0% [19.2%, 65.7%]	60.7%	46.5
Gemini 3 Flash	0.400 [0.131, 1.040]	37.0% [18.5%, 64.3%]	60.7%	45.8
Grok 4.1 Fast	0.400 [0.109, 1.191]	37.0% [16.5%, 68.4%]	60.7%	51.9
Grok 4.5	0.410 [0.105, 1.128]	36.5% [17.3%, 69.3%]	60.1%	52

Model	ETI median [90%]	Top rate median [90%]	Revenue-max median	Top-rate 90% width (pp)
GPT-5.4	0.420 [0.150, 0.996]	35.9% [19.1%, 61.1%]	59.5%	42
GPT-5.4 mini	0.437 [0.116, 1.377]	35.0% [14.6%, 67.1%]	58.6%	52.5
GPT-5.6 Sol	0.431 [0.150, 1.165]	35.3% [16.8%, 61.1%]	58.9%	44.3
Claude Fable 5	0.437 [0.151, 1.076]	35.0% [17.9%, 60.9%]	58.6%	42.9
Grok 4.3	0.439 [0.133, 1.091]	34.9% [17.8%, 64.0%]	58.4%	46.2
MiniMax M3	0.438 [0.122, 1.330]	34.9% [15.0%, 65.9%]	58.5%	50.9
Claude Sonnet 5	0.471 [0.145, 1.146]	33.3% [17.0%, 61.9%]	56.7%	44.9
GPT-5.6 Terra	0.492 [0.166, 1.182]	32.4% [16.6%, 58.7%]	55.6%	42.1
DeepSeek V4 Pro	0.479 [0.073, 1.808]	32.9% [11.5%, 76.3%]	56.3%	64.7
GLM-5.2	0.495 [0.156, 1.226]	32.2% [16.1%, 60.1%]	55.5%	44
Claude Sonnet 4.6	0.500 [0.138, 1.282]	32.0% [15.5%, 63.1%]	55.2%	47.6
Grok 4.20	0.500 [0.174, 1.243]	32.0% [15.9%, 57.5%]	55.2%	41.6
Kimi K2.6	0.499 [0.146, 1.241]	32.1% [15.9%, 61.7%]	55.3%	45.8
Claude Haiku 4.5	0.502 [0.145, 1.299]	31.9% [15.3%, 61.9%]	55.1%	46.6
GPT-5.4 nano	0.546 [0.151, 1.461]	30.1% [13.9%, 60.9%]	53.1%	47
Qwen 3.7 Max	0.555 [0.161, 1.415]	29.8% [14.3%, 59.4%]	52.6%	45.1

5.4 Convention clarifications in the main prompt

Two quantities with well-documented convention ambiguity have direction-first sign clarifiers embedded in the v4 main prompt: the prime-age income elasticity (whether extra non-labor income raises or reduces hours is a sign question) and the capital-gains realizations elasticity (whether epsilon is taken w.r.t. the tax rate tau or the net-of-tax rate (1 - tau) flips the

sign). The clarifier names no conventional direction — it says “ $\varepsilon > 0$ if and only if X raises Y; $\varepsilon < 0$ if and only if X reduces Y” for each quantity, which fixes the sign-of-reported-number $\leftrightarrow$ behavioral-direction mapping without asserting which direction is empirically right. The clarifier lists the $\varepsilon > 0$ clause first in all cases, which is itself a minor ordering-anchoring choice; a full treatment would randomize clause order across runs. Under v4, the canonical income elasticity center is negative for 25 of 26 models — the exception is gemini-3.5-flash’s bimodal +0.011 mean discussed above — and inside the review band for 22 of 26. The other out-of-band centers are negative but sit outside the band. The Armington and IES clarifications continue to produce meaningful cross-prompt deltas (Appendix Tables A7, A8). The capital-gains convention audit (Appendix Table A9) elicits both parameterizations of the same economic object to test whether each model answers consistently across conventions.

A second prompt-sensitivity check on the macro-and-trade side confirms the same methodological point: a 26-model follow-up on the Armington elasticity with an explicit top-level-import-versus-domestic clarification shifts pooled centers downward for most models (Appendix Table A7). Some cross-model disagreement reflects object-definition differences the base prompt underspecifies, not substantive belief disagreement.

5.5 What correlates with a model’s answers?

Two exploratory cross-model cuts close the results. Both are descriptive associations over a convenience census of models — every model differs from every other on architecture, training data, organization, and serving path at once — so I report rank statistics with permutation p-values, adjust for the full test family, and pre-commit to the framing that nothing here is causal.

The first cut joins the panel to PolicyBench, PolicyEngine’s policy-calculation benchmark, on its headline metric: the household-weighted share of predictions within one dollar of the reference answer (US, no-tools condition, pinned release dashboard-data-20260710; 23 of the 26 panel models appear on the leaderboard — all but gpt-5.4, grok-4.20, and grok-4.1-fast). Table 5 reports the per-model join and Table 6 the correlations for two predictors — the overall within-\$1 rate and a domain-matched tax-only version built from the benchmark’s seven tax variables. Models that score higher on policy calculation elicit lower taxable-income elasticities: Spearman $\rho = -0.51$ and -0.50 under the two predictors (raw p of 0.014 and 0.017, $n = 23$). Through the Saez formula that is the same statement as “more capable models imply higher optimal top rates,” so Table 6 reports the top-rate row as a derived transform, not an additional test. Across the eight-test family, the smallest Holm-adjusted p-value is 0.116 (Benjamini-Hochberg 0.070): nothing survives correction, and the association reads as suggestive, not established. It is, however, stable in sign under leave-one-organization-out deletion (ρ between -0.45 and -0.59 across all nine omissions) and under an organization-block permutation that moves score vectors as whole-lab units. Interval tightness shows no comparable association with capability.

Table 5. Panel joined to the PolicyBench leaderboard.

Note: Per-model summary joining the elicitation panel to the published PolicyBench leaderboard (PolicyEngine/policybench dashboard-data-20260710, US, no-tools, household-weighted within-\$1 rate — the leaderboard headline). Width rank averages tie-averaged 90 percent interval-width ranks across the canonical panel (1 = tightest). Implied top rates come from Table 4’s threshold-normalized log-utility mapping. Dashes mark models outside the PolicyBench panel.

Model	Organization	Wave	Policy-Bench within-\$1	ETI median	Implied top rate	Avg width rank
Gemini 3.1 Pro	Google	April 2026	77.9	0.351	40.2%	9.2
Gemini 3.5 Flash	Google	July 2026 frontier	76.2	0.357	39.8%	11.1
GPT-5.5	OpenAI	July 2026 frontier	83.5	0.369	39.0%	12.4
GPT-5.6 Luna	OpenAI	July 2026 GPT-5.6	84.5	0.377	38.4%	21.8
Claude Opus 4.8	Anthropic	July 2026 frontier	72.6	0.383	38.0%	9.1
Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite	Google	April 2026	76.1	0.389	37.7%	11.6
Claude Opus 4.7	Anthropic	April 2026	77.4	0.400	37.0%	7.7
Gemini 3 Flash	Google	April 2026	76.9	0.400	37.0%	10.6
Grok 4.1 Fast	xAI	April 2026	—	0.400	37.0%	15.8
Grok 4.5	xAI	July 2026 late	80.9	0.410	36.5%	15.2
GPT-5.4	OpenAI	April 2026	—	0.420	35.9%	12.6
GPT-5.6 Sol	OpenAI	July 2026 GPT-5.6	88.7	0.431	35.3%	14.3
GPT-5.4 mini	OpenAI	April 2026	70.5	0.437	35.0%	19.3
Claude Fable 5	Anthropic	July 2026 frontier	79.9	0.437	35.0%	5.8
Grok 4.3	xAI	July 2026 frontier	77.2	0.439	34.9%	15.2

Model	Organization	Wave	Policy-Bench within-\$1	ETI median	Implied top rate	Avg width rank
MiniMax M3	MiniMax	July 2026 independent labs	72.4	0.438	34.9%	15.8
Claude Sonnet 5	Anthropic	July 2026 frontier	69.4	0.471	33.3%	8.1
DeepSeek V4 Pro	DeepSeek	July 2026 independent labs	76.1	0.479	32.9%	16.5
GPT-5.6 Terra	OpenAI	July 2026 GPT-5.6	83.4	0.492	32.4%	11.5
GLM-5.2	Zhipu AI	July 2026 independent labs	73.1	0.495	32.2%	17.2
Kimi K2.6	Moonshot AI	July 2026 independent labs	64.6	0.499	32.1%	18.9
Claude Sonnet 4.6	Anthropic	April 2026	77.1	0.500	32.0%	11.2
Grok 4.20	xAI	April 2026	—	0.500	32.0%	19.5
Claude Haiku 4.5	Anthropic	April 2026	71.7	0.502	31.9%	7.8
GPT-5.4 nano	OpenAI	April 2026	62.3	0.546	30.1%	15.8
Qwen 3.7 Max	Alibaba	July 2026 independent labs	73.6	0.555	29.8%	16.9

Table 6. Capability correlations with elicited outcomes.

Note: Spearman rank correlations between the PolicyBench within-\$1 rate (PolicyEngine/policybench dashboard-data-20260710, US, no-tools) and per-model elicitation outcomes, with raw two-sided permutation p-values (20,000 draws, fixed seed; exact when $n \leq 8$) plus Holm and Benjamini-Hochberg adjustments across the eight non-derived tests spanning both predictors. The top-rate row is the same ETI hypothesis under a monotone transformation, not an additional test. Descriptive: models differ across every axis at once, so these are cross-family associations, not causal effects.

Predictor	Outcome	Models	Spearman rho	Raw permutation p	Holm-adjusted p	BH-adjusted p	Family size	Derived
Tax within-\$1 (domain-matched)	Mean	center	, labor-and-tax	23	0.096	0.662	1.000	0.883
Tax within-\$1 (domain-matched)	Mean	center	, macro-and-trade	23	0.159	0.470	1.000	0.753
Tax within-\$1 (domain-matched)	Avg interval-width rank (1 = tightest)	23	-0.318	0.139	0.836	0.372	8	no
Tax within-\$1 (domain-matched)	ETI pooled median	23	-0.496	0.017	0.122	0.070	8	no
Tax within-\$1 (domain-matched)	Implied optimal top rate (%) — derived, monotone transform of ETI — not an additional test	23	0.496	0.017	0.122	0.070	8	yes

Predictor	Outcome	Models	Spearman rho	Raw permutation p	Holm-adjusted p	BH-adjusted p	Family size	Derived
Overall within-\$1 (leader-board headline)	Mean	center	, labor-and-tax	23	0.061	0.782	1.000	0.894
Overall within-\$1 (leader-board headline)	Mean	center	, macro-and-trade	23	0.029	0.901	1.000	0.901
Overall within-\$1 (leader-board headline)	Avg interval-width rank (1 = tightest)	23	-0.158	0.468	1.000	0.753	8	no
Overall within-\$1 (leader-board headline)	ETI pooled median	23	-0.506	0.014	0.116	0.070	8	no

Predictor	Outcome	Models	Spearman rho	Raw permutation p	Holm-adjusted p	BH-adjusted p	Family size	Derived
Overall within-\$1 (leader-board head-line)	Implied optimal top rate (%) — derived, monotone transform of ETI — not an additional test	23	0.506	0.014	0.116	0.070	8	yes

The second cut groups the panel by lab home country: twenty-one models from four US organizations against five from Chinese labs. The Chinese-lab models imply lower optimal top rates (median 32.2% versus 35.9%, an exact group-label permutation $p = 0.023$ on the difference in medians), through visibly higher elicited taxable-income elasticities (median ETI 0.495 versus 0.420, $p = 0.019$), and they state wider intervals (average width rank 16.9 versus 11.6, $p = 0.070$). Four caveats bound this comparison. Lab country is perfectly confounded with the serving path — every Chinese-lab model ran through OpenRouter’s JSON mode — and with the elicitation wave; the five models also ran with uniformly high completion budgets and provider-default reasoning (8,000-16,000 tokens, a configuration only seven US models share), which bears most directly on the width contrast; the prompts are English-language, so the comparison measures these labs’ models as English-prompted policy assistants, not Chinese-language deployments; and with groups of 5 and 21, the exact permutation distribution over medians remains coarse — the observed ETI contrast sits in the fourth most extreme of its achievable classes — so these results are directional. Table 7 applies the same multiplicity standard as the capability cut — Holm and Benjamini-Hochberg over the cut’s four-outcome family, with the top-rate row again a derived transform of the ETI row: the smallest Holm-adjusted p-value is 0.078, so nothing in this cut survives correction either.

Table 7. US-lab versus Chinese-lab medians.

Note: US-lab versus Chinese-lab medians with exact group-label permutation p-values on the difference in medians, and Holm and Benjamini-Hochberg adjustment over the four-outcome family (* = the top-rate row is a derived transform of the ETI row and mirrors its adjusted values rather than entering the family). Exploratory: lab country is perfectly confounded with

the serving path (every Chinese-lab model ran through OpenRouter JSON mode) and with elicitation wave, and co-varies with completion budget and reasoning configuration; prompts are English-language, and the group sizes (5 versus 20) put a floor near 0.02-0.05 on attainable p-values.

Outcome	US median (n)	China median (n)	China - US	Permuta- tion p	Holm p	BH p
Implied optimal top rate (%)	35.917 (21)	32.235 (5)	-3.682	0.023	0.078*	0.078*
ETI pooled median	0.420 (21)	0.495 (5)	+0.075	0.019	0.078	0.078
Avg interval- width rank (1 = tightest)	11.615 (21)	16.923 (5)	+5.308	0.070	0.190	0.094
Mean	center	, labor-and- tax	0.369 (21)	0.324 (5)	-0.045	0.063
Mean	center	, macro- and-trade	1.164 (21)	1.038 (5)	-0.127	0.249

6 Interpretation

The protocol identifies prompt-conditioned response distributions under a fixed elicitation design — it adjudicates no model as correct and recovers no latent stable priors. That object is narrower than “belief” in a deep psychological sense, and it is exactly the object users meet when they interact with these systems through prompts.

That matters for three reasons.

First, the domain-specific ordering means no model carries one general “elasticity ideology.” A model can look relatively high-response on labor-and-tax quantities and relatively low-response on macro-and-trade quantities, or vice versa.

Second, pooled predictive uncertainty is itself informative. Some models behave as if the relevant literature is tight and settled; others behave as if the same quantities are wide-open or as if their own answers are unstable across repeated runs. Users interacting with these models will experience that difference directly. One caveat applies to the three no-sampling-parameter Claude models (Fable 5, Opus 4.8, Sonnet 5), whose between-run variation arises under provider-default sampling instead of the panel’s temperature = 1.0; Appendix Table

A15 shows this matters little in practice, because the between-run component contributes a median of 0 to 2 percent of pooled predictive variance for every model — the models’ own stated quantiles dominate the widths, and the sampling regime does not touch those.

Third, prompt sensitivity is part of the estimand, not a nuisance to hide. The income-elasticity sign clarification shows that a fixed protocol can still identify a mixture of economic judgment and convention handling — which calls for describing the object precisely and investing in quantity-specific prompt design.

This also clarifies the relationship between the present paper and the LLM uncertainty literature discussed above. Papers such as *Can LLMs Express Their Uncertainty? An Empirical Evaluation of Confidence Elicitation in LLMs* (2023), *Generating with Confidence* (2023), and *LLMs Are Overconfident* (2025) mostly evaluate whether uncertainty reports line up with eventual correctness. By contrast, this paper asks how models respond when the target is a contested economic parameter and the disagreement itself is economically interesting. In that sense, the project is closer to synthetic expert elicitation than to benchmark evaluation.

7 Limitations

This is an initial results paper, not a final measurement of latent model beliefs.

The current limitations are straightforward:

- the protocol identifies prompt-conditioned responses, not stable latent priors
- the main panel is memory-only in design and almost entirely tool-free in realized behavior; retrieval-augmented and tool-using arms are still secondary
- the current full dataset still contains simulation-facing response coefficients and one labeled legacy row, even though the headline tables now separate them
- the current paper focuses on elasticities, not the broader OG-USA-style parameter set
- the interval analysis is descriptive; calibration against resolved numeric tasks is still modular but secondary
- citation strings are noisy and need normalization before they can support serious bibliometric analysis

8 Appendix

8.1 Stability check

Appendix Table A1 reports a simple stability check for the choice of $R = 15$. Across the canonical 13-quantity subpanel (338 cells at every prefix length), the median absolute difference between the first 10 runs in a cell and the full 15-run pooled center is only 0.002; the corresponding

median difference in pooled 90 percent width is 0.010. Using only the first 5 runs is noisier, but still modest at the median.

Appendix Table A1. Prefix stability for the canonical subpanel.

Note: Prefix stability on the 13-quantity canonical subpanel. Rows compare pooled summaries from the first 5 or 10 runs in a cell to the full 15-run pooled summary.

Runs used	Cells compared	Median abs change in pooled center	90th pct abs change in pooled center	Median abs change in pooled width	90th pct abs change in pooled width
5	338	0.005	0.048	0.027	0.244
10	338	0.002	0.027	0.01	0.141
15	338	0	0	0	0

8.2 Pooling robustness

Appendix Table A2 compares model-level predictive-uncertainty rankings under three interval constructions: the headline pooled mixture interval, a REML random-effects predictive interval, and a Bayesian hierarchical predictive interval. The rankings move somewhat, but the changes are not large enough to overturn the broad qualitative picture. Claude Fable 5, Claude Haiku 4.5, Gemini 3.1 Pro, and Claude Sonnet 5 remain among the tighter models across all three constructions, while GPT-5.4 mini, Grok 4.20, and GPT-5.6 Luna remain toward the wide end. The largest rank spread is 3.92 positions for MiniMax M3.

Appendix Table A2. Predictive-uncertainty ranking under alternative pooling methods.

Note: Canonical 13-quantity subpanel. Average predictive-uncertainty ranks are computed under the headline pooled mixture interval, the REML predictive interval, and the Bayesian predictive interval.

Model	Avg pooled rank	Avg REML rank	Avg Bayes rank	Max rank spread
Claude Fable 5	5.77	6.5	5.92	0.73
Claude Opus 4.7	7.69	10.85	9.77	3.15
Claude Haiku 4.5	7.85	6.77	6.69	1.15
Claude Sonnet 5	8	10	9.54	2
Claude Opus 4.8	9.12	12.35	11.77	3.23
Gemini 3.1 Pro	9.19	8.15	8.31	1.04
Gemini 3 Flash	10.62	10.77	10.08	0.69
Gemini 3.5 Flash	11.08	13.23	14.38	3.31
Claude Sonnet 4.6	11.23	15	14	3.77

Model	Avg pooled rank	Avg REML rank	Avg Bayes rank	Max rank spread
GPT-5.6 Terra	11.54	11.85	12.46	0.92
Gemini 3.1	11.62	11.85	11.62	0.23
Flash-Lite				
GPT-5.5	12.38	14.77	14	2.38
GPT-5.4	12.62	15.15	14.31	2.54
GPT-5.6 Sol	14.31	16.23	15.85	1.92
Grok 4.3	15.15	14.81	14.23	0.92
Grok 4.5	15.23	16	14.58	1.42
MiniMax M3	15.77	11.85	14.23	3.92
Grok 4.1 Fast	15.81	14.92	14.35	1.46
GPT-5.4 nano	15.85	13.23	15.15	2.62
DeepSeek V4	16.54	13.31	15	3.23
Pro				
Qwen 3.7 Max	16.92	15.19	15.5	1.73
GLM-5.2	17.15	13.92	15.15	3.23
Kimi K2.6	18.92	15.85	16.46	3.08
GPT-5.4 mini	19.35	17.77	17.81	1.58
Grok 4.20	19.54	19.08	18.38	1.15
GPT-5.6 Luna	21.77	21.62	21.46	0.31

8.3 Leave-one-organization-out stability

Appendix Table A3 asks whether any single organization drives the subpanel rankings, deleting each of the nine organizations in turn. None does. Across both the labor-and-tax and macro-and-trade subpanels, the leave-one-organization-out Spearman correlation with the full-panel ranking stays between 0.991 and 1.0. Some top spots do flip when one organization drops out, especially on the smaller three-quantity macro-and-trade panel, but the broad ordering holds.

Appendix Table A3. Leave-one-organization-out ranking sensitivity.

Note: Leave-one-organization-out sensitivity of the average absolute-elasticity ranking on the labor-and-tax and macro-and-trade canonical subpanels.

Subpanel	Omitted organization	Spearman rho	Top retained model, full panel	Top retained model, leave-out	Max avg-rank shift
Labor/tax	Alibaba	0.999	Claude Sonnet 4.6	Claude Sonnet 4.6	1
Labor/tax	Anthropic	0.994	Grok 4.5	Grok 4.5	5.5

Subpanel	Omitted organization	Spearman rho	Top retained model, full panel	Top retained model, leave-out	Max avg-rank shift
Labor/tax	DeepSeek	0.999	Claude Sonnet 4.6	Claude Sonnet 4.6	0.833
Labor/tax	Google	0.998	Claude Sonnet 4.6	Claude Sonnet 4.6	2.5
Labor/tax	MiniMax	0.999	Claude Sonnet 4.6	Claude Sonnet 4.6	0.833
Labor/tax	Moonshot AI	0.999	Claude Sonnet 4.6	Claude Sonnet 4.6	1
Labor/tax	OpenAI	0.996	Claude Sonnet 4.6	Claude Sonnet 4.6	5.667
Labor/tax	Zhipu AI	1	Claude Sonnet 4.6	Claude Sonnet 4.6	0.833
Labor/tax	xAI	0.999	Claude Sonnet 4.6	Claude Sonnet 4.6	3.5
Macro/trade	Alibaba	1	Grok 4.3	Grok 4.3	0.333
Macro/trade	Anthropic	0.997	Grok 4.3	Grok 4.3	4
Macro/trade	DeepSeek	1	Grok 4.3	Grok 4.3	1
Macro/trade	Google	0.998	Grok 4.3	Grok 4.3	3.667
Macro/trade	MiniMax	0.999	Grok 4.3	Grok 4.3	0.667
Macro/trade	Moonshot AI	1	Grok 4.3	Grok 4.3	1
Macro/trade	OpenAI	0.991	Grok 4.3	Grok 4.20	7
Macro/trade	Zhipu AI	1	Grok 4.3	Grok 4.3	1
Macro/trade	xAI	0.999	GPT-5.6 Luna	GPT-5.4 nano	3.667

8.4 Alternative quantile-to-distribution rule

Appendix Table A4 replaces the headline piecewise-uniform reconstruction with a cruder transformed-normal approximation calibrated to p05, p50, and p95 for each run. The resulting predictive-uncertainty ranks move more at 26 models than they did at 17: the largest average rank change is 4.23 positions for MiniMax M3, and only 9 of 26 models move by less than one rank position. The ordering is therefore rule-sensitive in the middle of the pack; the paper’s conclusions rest on the extremes and on coarse groupings, which hold under both rules, not on fine mid-pack placements.

Appendix Table A4. Sensitivity to the within-run distribution rule.

Note: Canonical 13-quantity subpanel. The alternative rule approximates each run as a transformed normal calibrated to p05, p50, and p95 instead of the headline piecewise-uniform

quantile-bin reconstruction.

Model	Avg piecewise-uniform rank	Avg transformed-normal rank	Rank shift
Claude Fable 5	5.77	6.77	1
Claude Opus 4.7	7.69	11.08	3.38
Claude Haiku 4.5	7.85	6.69	-1.15
Claude Sonnet 5	8	9.85	1.85
Claude Opus 4.8	9.12	12.27	3.15
Gemini 3.1 Pro	9.19	8.23	-0.96
Gemini 3 Flash	10.62	10.54	-0.08
Gemini 3.5 Flash	11.08	12.38	1.31
Claude Sonnet 4.6	11.23	15.04	3.81
GPT-5.6 Terra	11.54	11.31	-0.23
Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite	11.62	11.54	-0.08
GPT-5.5	12.38	14.38	2
GPT-5.4	12.62	13.77	1.15
GPT-5.6 Sol	14.31	16.38	2.08
Grok 4.3	15.15	14.62	-0.54
Grok 4.5	15.23	15.77	0.54
MiniMax M3	15.77	11.54	-4.23
Grok 4.1 Fast	15.81	14.15	-1.65
GPT-5.4 nano	15.85	14.77	-1.08
DeepSeek V4 Pro	16.54	13.69	-2.85
Qwen 3.7 Max	16.92	14.85	-2.08
GLM-5.2	17.15	15.85	-1.31
Kimi K2.6	18.92	15.77	-3.15
GPT-5.4 mini	19.35	18.46	-0.88
Grok 4.20	19.54	19	-0.54
GPT-5.6 Luna	21.77	22.31	0.54

8.5 Tool-access robustness

The paper’s main estimand is a memory-based elicitation design. To check whether that framing is misleading in practice, I also ran an earlier GPT-only robustness arm that gave the models web search and code interpreter access. That arm covered an earlier eight-quantity subset, so it does not compare directly to the current 26-quantity main panel. Its value is narrower: it shows whether tool access materially changed realized behavior.

In that archived tool-access arm, actual tool uptake was rare. Across all 360 requests, the models used web search in only 9 cases (2.5%) and code interpreter never. Full GPT-5.4 never

used a tool; GPT-5.4 mini used web search in 2 / 120 requests; and GPT-5.4 nano used web search in 7 / 120 requests. The appendix table below summarizes those counts.

Appendix Table A5. Tool use in the archived GPT-only tool-access arm.

Note: Archived GPT-only robustness arm with full web and code-interpreter access on the earlier 8-quantity panel (8 quantities x 15 runs x 3 GPT models = 360 requests). In realized behavior, tool uptake was rare and code interpreter was never used.

Model	Requests	Requests with web use	Share with web use	Total web calls	Requests with code use	Share with code use	Total code calls
GPT-5.4	120	0	0.0%	0	0	0.0%	0
GPT-5.4	120	2	1.7%	2	0	0.0%	0
mini							
GPT-5.4	120	7	5.8%	7	0	0.0%	0
nano							
All GPT models	360	9	2.5%	9	0	0.0%	0

8.6 Canonical quantity disagreement

Appendix Table A6 reports quantity-level disagreement on the canonical 13-quantity panel. The final column scales cross-model spread by the average pooled 90 percent width. On this metric, no canonical quantity has cross-model spread larger than average within-model predictive width.

Appendix Table A6. Canonical quantity disagreement.

Note: Canonical elasticity subpanel only, sorted by cross-model spread in pooled point estimates. Simulation-facing PolicyEngine coefficients are broken out in separate appendix-style tables.

Quantity	Lowest model	Lowest center	Highest model	Highest center	Spread	Mean pooled 90% width	Spread / mean width
Arming- ton elasticity	Qwen 3.7 Max	1.433	Claude Sonnet 5	3.18	1.747	5.395	0.324

Quantity	Lowest model	Lowest center	Highest model	Highest center	Spread	Mean pooled 90% width	Spread / mean width
Intertem- poral elasticity of substi- tution	MiniMax M3	0.483	Gemini 3.1 Pro	1.467	0.983	1.79	0.549
Capital gains re- alizations elasticity	GPT-5.4 mini	-0.93	Gemini 3.5 Flash	0.01	0.94	1.942	0.484
Coeffi- cient of relative risk aversion	Claude Haiku 4.5	1.567	GLM-5.2	2.1	0.533	8.165	0.065
Employ- ment participa- tion elasticity of single mothers	GPT-5.4 nano	0.213	Qwen 3.7 Max	0.717	0.503	1.249	0.403
Frisch elasticity of labor supply	Claude Haiku 4.5	0.283	GPT-5.4 nano	0.593	0.31	1.315	0.236
Elasticity of substi- tution between capital and labor	Qwen 3.7 Max	0.593	GPT-5.4 mini	0.883	0.29	1.11	0.261
Elasticity of taxable income	Gemini 3.1 Pro	0.35	Qwen 3.7 Max	0.554	0.204	1.063	0.192
TFP per- sistence	GPT-5.4 nano	0.823	GPT-5.6 Terra	0.956	0.133	0.221	0.602

Quantity	Lowest model	Lowest center	Highest model	Highest center	Spread	Mean pooled 90% width	Spread / mean width
Uncom- pensated wage elasticity of labor supply	Gemini 3.1 Pro	0.04	Grok 4.5	0.168	0.128	0.608	0.211
Income elasticity of labor supply	Grok 4.20	-0.107	Gemini 3.5 Flash	0.011	0.118	0.384	0.307
Capital share in produc- tion	Claude Haiku 4.5	0.307	GPT-5.6 Luna	0.355	0.048	0.201	0.239
Annual discount factor	Grok 4.20	0.959	GPT-5.6 Terra	0.982	0.023	0.087	0.26

8.7 Armington clarification follow-up

Appendix Table A7 reports a second prompt-sensitivity probe. For the Armington elasticity, the follow-up prompt made explicit that the target was the top-level import-versus-domestic substitution elasticity, not source-country substitution or a sector-level import-demand elasticity. Across all 26 model reruns, that clarification shifts pooled centers downward or leaves them essentially unchanged; the only increases are small (+0.013 for Claude Fable 5, +0.033 for Qwen 3.7 Max, +0.167 for MiniMax M3). The largest decreases appear for Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite (-0.767), Claude Sonnet 5 (-0.647), and Claude Sonnet 4.6 and GPT-5.4 (-0.433 each). Two clarified intervals (Gemini 3 Flash, Gemini 3.1 Pro) reach exactly 0 at their lower end, which reflects the registry support floor, not an elicited quantile. I interpret the deltas as further evidence that even apparently standard macro parameters can hide meaningful object-definition ambiguity.

Appendix Table A7. Armington clarification follow-up.

Note: Change in the Armington elasticity after clarifying that the target is the top-level import-versus-domestic elasticity, not source-country or sector-level substitution.

Model	Old center	Clarified center	Change	Old pooled 90% interval	Clarified pooled 90% interval
Claude Fable 5	1.987	2	0.013	[0.9024, 4.738]	[0.9508, 3.995]
Claude Haiku 4.5	1.5	1.387	-0.113	[0.6154, 2.979]	[0.4396, 2.787]
Claude Opus 4.7	1.533	1.5	-0.033	[0.6788, 4.574]	[0.6687, 3.983]
Claude Opus 4.8	2.4	2.033	-0.367	[0.9516, 6.965]	[0.9494, 5.661]
Claude Sonnet 4.6	2.267	1.833	-0.433	[0.8333, 6.615]	[0.7826, 4.295]
Claude Sonnet 5	3.18	2.533	-0.647	[1.161, 7.883]	[1.002, 5.995]
DeepSeek V4 Pro	1.853	1.513	-0.34	[0.5548, 5.321]	[0.3605, 4.728]
GLM-5.2	2.073	1.727	-0.347	[0.6104, 6.707]	[0.5482, 4.848]
GPT-5.4	2.5	2.067	-0.433	[1.08, 5.997]	[0.9368, 5]
GPT-5.4 mini	2.3	2.1	-0.2	[0.8105, 8.107]	[0.8221, 6.607]
GPT-5.4 nano	2.233	1.993	-0.24	[0.836, 5.921]	[0.8427, 4.391]
GPT-5.5	2.153	1.94	-0.213	[0.7121, 6.78]	[0.6748, 6.087]
GPT-5.6 Luna	2.467	2.1	-0.367	[0.5303, 9.158]	[0.5389, 7.603]
GPT-5.6 Sol	2.067	1.7	-0.367	[0.6556, 6.546]	[0.6247, 4.906]
GPT-5.6 Terra	2	1.9	-0.1	[0.8897, 5]	[0.8308, 4.965]
Gemini 3 Flash	1.633	1.573	-0.061	[0.6512, 5.783]	[0, 5.903]
Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite	2.367	1.6	-0.767	[0.6797, 7.27]	[0.5283, 4.856]
Gemini 3.1 Pro	1.653	1.444	-0.209	[0.5471, 4.933]	[0, 5.592]
Gemini 3.5 Flash	1.753	1.387	-0.367	[0.6111, 5.062]	[0.5137, 3.815]
Grok 4.1 Fast	1.5	1.5	0	[0.6512, 3]	[0.7059, 3]

Model	Old center	Clarified center	Change	Old pooled 90% interval	Clarified pooled 90% interval
Grok 4.20	2	1.967	-0.033	[0.5034, 7.71]	[0.5084, 7.252]
Grok 4.3	2.94	2.7	-0.24	[0.8114, 9.02]	[0.7451, 8.039]
Grok 4.5	2.467	2.433	-0.033	[0.7283, 7.604]	[0.9137, 6.944]
Kimi K2.6	1.833	1.587	-0.247	[0.5653, 5.968]	[0.5596, 4.487]
MiniMax M3	1.987	2.153	0.167	[0.8013, 5.08]	[0.8077, 5.725]
Qwen 3.7 Max	1.433	1.467	0.033	[0.496, 4.412]	[0.5137, 3.905]

8.8 IES clarification follow-up

Appendix Table A8 reports a third prompt-sensitivity probe on the intertemporal elasticity of substitution. The follow-up prompt makes explicit that the target is the annual macro-calibration IES for nondurable consumption, not a generic inverse-CRRA or asset-pricing object. Under the clarification, most pooled centers stay near 0.5 or move slightly downward; the largest shift is -0.842 for Gemini 3.1 Pro (from 1.467 to 0.625), which suggests the base prompt’s IES interpretation was picking up more of the inverse-CRRA reading than the macro-calibration reading for that model. This is a narrower ambiguity than the Armington and income-sign cases, but it is conceptually important because the IES is often conflated with risk aversion in casual model discussions.

Appendix Table A8. IES clarification follow-up.

Note: Full-panel follow-up across all 11 models. Change in the intertemporal elasticity of substitution after clarifying that the target is the annual macro-calibration IES for nondurable consumption, not a generic inverse-CRRA or asset-pricing object.

Model	Old center	Clarified center	Change	Old pooled 90% interval	Clarified pooled 90% interval
Claude Fable 5	0.5	0.407	-0.093	[0.1, 1.661]	[0.0692, 1.346]
Claude Haiku 4.5	0.5	0.5	0	[0.2058, 1.188]	[0.2115, 1.193]

Model	Old center	Clarified center	Change	Old pooled 90% interval	Clarified pooled 90% interval
Claude Opus 4.7	0.5	0.5	0	[0.092, 1.965]	[0.1, 1.483]
Claude Opus 4.8	0.5	0.5	0	[0.1, 1.5]	[0.1, 1.455]
Claude Sonnet 4.6	0.5	0.5	0	[0.1, 1.5]	[0.1, 1.491]
Claude Sonnet 5	0.5	0.5	0	[0.1024, 1.482]	[0.1024, 1.199]
DeepSeek V4 Pro	0.527	0.5	-0.027	[0.06604, 2.054]	[0.07207, 1.918]
GLM-5.2	0.533	0.493	-0.04	[0.1018, 1.809]	[0.1126, 1.466]
GPT-5.4	0.5	0.5	0	[0.1133, 1.388]	[0.1862, 1.2]
GPT-5.4 mini	0.54	0.5	-0.04	[0.1014, 1.924]	[0.092, 1.498]
GPT-5.4 nano	0.747	0.733	-0.013	[0.2167, 1.956]	[0.2118, 1.923]
GPT-5.5	0.5	0.41	-0.09	[0.06411, 1.664]	[0.04859, 1.423]
GPT-5.6 Luna	0.66	0.683	0.023	[0.1598, 2.248]	[0.16, 2.03]
GPT-5.6 Sol	0.56	0.5	-0.06	[0.1091, 1.727]	[0.1012, 1.466]
GPT-5.6 Terra	0.5	0.5	0	[0.2, 1.191]	[0.1613, 1.157]
Gemini 3 Flash	0.5	0.478	-0.022	[0.1, 1.979]	[0, 1.667]
Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite	0.5	0.5	0	[0.1, 1.431]	[0.1018, 1.198]
Gemini 3.1 Pro	1.467	0.625	-0.842	[0.2857, 2.499]	[0, 1.767]
Gemini 3.5 Flash	0.933	0.567	-0.367	[0.07895, 2.11]	[0.1037, 1.899]
Grok 4.1 Fast	0.5	0.5	0	[0.1474, 1.97]	[0.1429, 2]
Grok 4.20	0.967	0.667	-0.3	[0.2004, 3.611]	[0.1211, 3.224]
Grok 4.3	0.873	0.863	-0.01	[0.2, 2.457]	[0.2164, 2.421]

Model	Old center	Clarified center	Change	Old pooled 90% interval	Clarified pooled 90% interval
Grok 4.5	0.933	0.833	-0.1	[0.1619, 2.494]	[0.1357, 2.462]
Kimi K2.6	0.73	0.563	-0.167	[0.1122, 2.678]	[0.1131, 1.668]
MiniMax M3	0.483	0.51	0.027	[0.1, 1.47]	[0.1099, 1.471]
Qwen 3.7 Max	0.627	0.492	-0.135	[0.1125, 2.018]	[0.09787, 1.492]

8.9 Capital-gains convention audit

Appendix Table A9 elicits both parameterizations of the capital-gains realizations elasticity under the v4 main prompt: the headline panel’s w.r.t.-tax-rate convention and a sibling quantity defined w.r.t. the net-of-tax rate. The identity $\varepsilon_\tau = -\frac{\tau}{1-\tau} \varepsilon_{1-\tau}$ inverts to $\tau = -\rho/(1-\rho)$ where $\rho = \varepsilon_\tau/\varepsilon_{1-\tau}$. I bootstrap the implied- τ distribution — drawing 1,000 independent pairs $(\varepsilon_{\tau,i}, \varepsilon_{1-\tau,j})$ from each model’s 15 tax-rate runs and 15 net-of-tax-rate runs and inverting per pair — instead of plugging the two pooled centers into the inversion once. The table reports the median and 90 percent interval of that distribution. The bootstrap median need not equal the plug-in ratio of medians: $\tau = -\rho/(1-\rho)$ is nonlinear in ρ , so Jensen’s inequality lets averaging implied- τ values across pairs move the center relative to the implied τ at the two pooled medians, and the bootstrap quantiles also make the residual uncertainty visible.²

The table uses two band anchors. The narrow [0.15, 0.37] window covers the U.S. top-bracket long-term-capital-gains envelope (federal LTCG top of 0.20, plus a 0.038 NIIT, plus the highest state LTCG layer); the wider (0.37, 0.55] window covers an ordinary-income-rate anchor (federal ordinary-income top plus high state). The table flags an implied median τ inside the first window as “LTCG-rate consistent,” inside the second as “ordinary-income-rate consistent,” outside both windows but still in (0, 1) as “plausible sign, outside bands,” and non-positive or greater than one as “out of band”. The “shared-tau coherence” column then flags the joint sign pattern of the two pooled medians: cells outside the canonical sign-consistent pattern (tax ≤ 0 , net ≥ 0) indicate that the model’s two answers are not jointly consistent with any single τ — either because the model holds two independent literature anchors, or because the model answered one convention with the opposite sign. Twenty-five of twenty-six models are

²A shared-tau coherence violation does not strictly demand a convention swap. A model could legitimately hold two defensible but internally independent magnitudes drawn from different literatures — for example, a net-of-tax elasticity anchored in a medium-run realizations study and a tax-rate elasticity anchored in a short-run timing study — in which case the bootstrap would still reveal joint incoherence even though neither individual answer is wrong. The audit therefore identifies joint incoherence under a single shared τ without labeling the underlying cause.

sign-consistent; the exception (GPT-5.4 nano) returns two negative medians, so the identity’s premise fails and no implied τ is defined for it. Among the sign-consistent models, one (Gemini 3.5 Flash) has a bootstrap distribution that straddles the $\rho = 1$ pole — only 65% of its draws fall in $(0, 1)$ — so the table flags it uninformative and assigns no band. The substantive finding concerns the remaining twenty-four: sixteen cluster in the ordinary-income-rate window and eight in the LTCG window, so feeding the models’ own responsiveness estimates into the inversion typically recovers an implied τ closer to the top marginal ordinary-income rate than to the top LTCG rate. This is the most direct internal-consistency check the design supports, since the sibling probes the exact same economic object from the other side.

Appendix Table A9. Capital-gains convention audit.

Note: Both capital-gains-realizations conventions elicited independently under prompt v4. Under the identity $\text{epsilon_taxrate} = -(\tau / (1 - \tau)) * \text{epsilon_netoftax}$, any model whose two answers are jointly consistent with a single τ prior implies one specific τ . The implied-tau column reports the median and 90 percent interval of 1000 bootstrap draws that independently sample one tax-rate run and one net-of-tax-rate run from the 15 runs of each; this is not the plug-in ratio of medians, which differs from the bootstrap median because $\tau = -\rho / (1 - \rho)$ is nonlinear in ρ (Jensen’s inequality). The band flag is computed against the bootstrap median. ‘LTCG-rate consistent’ marks an implied median τ in $[0.15, 0.37]$ (U.S. top-bracket long-term-capital-gains envelope, federal LTCG plus NIIT plus high state); ‘ordinary-income-rate consistent’ marks $(0.37, 0.55]$ (federal ordinary-income top plus high state); ‘plausible sign, outside bands’ marks $(0, 1)$ outside both windows; and ‘out of band’ marks a non-positive or > 1 median τ . The shared-tau coherence column flags the joint sign pattern of the two pooled medians: a model with $(\text{tax} < 0, \text{net} > 0)$ is sign-consistent with the identity, whereas (both positive, both negative, or reversed) indicates that the two answers are not jointly consistent with a single τ prior — either because the model holds two independent literature anchors, or because one convention was answered with the opposite sign.

Model	Organiza- tion	epsilon w.r.t. tax rate (median)	epsilon w.r.t. net-of- tax rate (median)	Implied tau median [90%]	Share of draws in (0, 1)	Shared- tau coherence	Band (LTCG [0.15, 0.37], ordinary- income [0.37, 0.55])
GPT-5.4 nano	OpenAI	-0.35	-0.2	— (premise fails)	—	both negative	not identified

Model	Organization	epsilon w.r.t. tax rate (median)	epsilon w.r.t. net-of- tax rate (median)	Implied tau median [90%]	Share of draws in (0, 1)	Shared- tau coherence	Band (LTCG [0.15, 0.37], ordinary- income [0.37, 0.55])
Claude Fable 5	Anthropic	-0.7	1.8	0.280 [0.250, 0.318]	100%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	LTCG- rate consis- tent
Claude Haiku 4.5	Anthropic	-0.8	0.8	0.500 [0.348, 0.552]	100%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	ordinary- income- rate consis- tent
Claude Opus 4.7	Anthropic	-0.7	0.7	0.500 [0.500, 0.500]	100%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	ordinary- income- rate consis- tent
Claude Opus 4.8	Anthropic	-0.7	0.7	0.500 [0.500, 0.538]	100%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	ordinary- income- rate consis- tent
Claude Sonnet 4.6	Anthropic	-0.7	3.5	0.167 [0.167, 0.189]	100%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	LTCG- rate consis- tent
Claude Sonnet 5	Anthropic	-0.6	0.6	0.500 [0.500, 0.538]	100%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	ordinary- income- rate consis- tent
DeepSeek V4 Pro	DeepSeek	-0.45	0.7	0.310 [0.067, 0.500]	100%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	LTCG- rate consis- tent

Model	Organization	epsilon w.r.t. tax rate (median)	epsilon w.r.t. net-of- tax rate (median)	Implied tau median [90%]	Share of draws in (0, 1)	Shared- tau coherence	Band (LTCG [0.15, 0.37], ordinary- income [0.37, 0.55])
GLM-5.2	Zhipu AI	-0.5	1.2	0.294 [0.091, 0.611]	100%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	LTCG- rate consis- tent
GPT-5.4	OpenAI	-0.7	0.9	0.450 [0.389, 0.571]	100%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	ordinary- income- rate consis- tent
GPT-5.4 mini	OpenAI	-0.8	1.2	0.500 [0.333, 0.636]	100%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	ordinary- income- rate consis- tent
GPT-5.5	OpenAI	-0.65	0.9	0.400 [0.207, 0.519]	100%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	ordinary- income- rate consis- tent
GPT-5.6 Luna	OpenAI	-0.5	0.7	0.417 [0.222, 0.682]	100%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	ordinary- income- rate consis- tent
GPT-5.6 Sol	OpenAI	-0.6	0.8	0.389 [0.250, 0.520]	100%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	ordinary- income- rate consis- tent
GPT-5.6 Terra	OpenAI	-0.35	0.7	0.364 [0.263, 0.545]	100%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	LTCG- rate consis- tent

Model	Organization	epsilon w.r.t. tax rate (median)	epsilon w.r.t. net-of- tax rate (median)	Implied tau median [90%]	Share of draws in (0, 1)	Shared- tau coherence	Band (LTCG [0.15, 0.37], ordinary- income [0.37, 0.55])
Gemini 3 Flash	Google	-0.8	0.8	0.500 [0.467, 0.515]	100%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	ordinary- income- rate consis- tent
Gemini 3.1 Flash- Lite	Google	-0.75	0.8	0.484 [0.318, 0.538]	100%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	ordinary- income- rate consis- tent
Gemini 3.1 Pro	Google	-0.7	2	0.259 [0.200, 0.483]	100%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	LTCG- rate consis- tent
Gemini 3.5 Flash	Google	-0.4	0.8	0.452 [-0.889, 3.250]	65%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	uninform- ative (pole- straddling)
Grok 4.1 Fast	xAI	-0.7	1.2	0.368 [0.149, 0.500]	100%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	LTCG- rate consis- tent
Grok 4.20	xAI	-0.5	0.65	0.417 [0.348, 0.478]	100%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	ordinary- income- rate consis- tent
Grok 4.3	xAI	-0.7	0.8	0.484 [0.411, 0.556]	100%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	ordinary- income- rate consis- tent

Model	Organization	epsilon w.r.t. tax rate (median)	epsilon w.r.t. net-of- tax rate (median)	Implied tau median [90%]	Share of draws in (0, 1)	Shared- tau coherence	Band (LTCG [0.15, 0.37], ordinary- income [0.37, 0.55])
Grok 4.5	xAI	-0.6	0.7	0.462 [0.368, 0.519]	100%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	ordinary- income- rate consis- tent
Kimi K2.6	Moon- shot AI	-0.5	0.65	0.400 [0.185, 0.560]	94%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	ordinary- income- rate consis- tent
MiniMax M3	MiniMax	-0.35	0.7	0.333 [0.059, 0.588]	100%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	LTCG- rate consis- tent
Qwen 3.7 Max	Alibaba	-0.7	0.7	0.500 [0.412, 0.588]	100%	sign- consistent (tax<0, net>0)	ordinary- income- rate consis- tent

9 Appendix: Simulation-Facing Coefficients

The simulation-facing substitution-response coefficients are substantively useful, but they are implementation-facing response parameters, not textbook elasticity objects, so I keep them out of the headline rankings and report them here.

Appendix Table A10. Simulation-facing model overview.

Note: Simulation-facing subpanel only: 12 PolicyEngine-style substitution-response coefficients used in a U.S. tax-benefit microsimulation. These rows are reported separately from the canonical elasticity panel because they are implementation-facing response parameters rather than standard elasticity objects.

Model	Organization	Avg abs-elasticity rank (1=highest)	Avg predictive-uncertainty rank (1=narrowest)	Mean absolute pooled center	Mean pooled 90% width	Success rate	Cost / successful run
GPT-5.4 nano	OpenAI	1.46	25.5	0.507	1.319	100.0%	\$0.0003
Grok 4.20	xAI	5.67	19.33	0.277	0.765	100.0%	\$0.0086
Grok 4.1 Fast	xAI	6.04	24.75	0.295	1.219	100.0%	\$0.0002
Qwen 3.7 Max	Alibaba	7.17	19.75	0.288	0.813	100.0%	—
GPT-5.6 Terra	OpenAI	7.25	15.42	0.272	0.658	100.0%	—
Claude Opus 4.7	Anthropic	7.33	14.25	0.267	0.637	100.0%	\$0.0216
Grok 4.5	xAI	7.83	16.42	0.266	0.665	100.0%	\$0.0064
Claude Opus 4.8	Anthropic	7.92	13.92	0.267	0.626	100.0%	\$0.0141
Grok 4.3	xAI	8.62	17.5	0.262	0.681	100.0%	\$0.0017
GLM-5.2	Zhipu AI	11.33	10.42	0.254	0.573	100.0%	—
Claude Haiku 4.5	Anthropic	11.5	17.25	0.247	0.678	100.0%	\$0.0031
Claude Sonnet 4.6	Anthropic	12.12	8.75	0.241	0.522	100.0%	\$0.0109
Kimi K2.6	Moonshot AI	12.71	18.33	0.24	0.707	100.0%	—
Claude Sonnet 5	Anthropic	14.67	13.25	0.228	0.631	100.0%	\$0.0073
Claude Fable 5	Anthropic	15	2.67	0.222	0.42	100.0%	\$0.0468
GPT-5.4 mini	OpenAI	15.17	20.83	0.218	0.78	100.0%	\$0.0010
GPT-5.6 Luna	OpenAI	15.42	21.42	0.216	0.797	100.0%	—
Gemini 3.1 Pro	Google	16.29	3	0.216	0.432	100.0%	\$0.0078
GPT-5.6 Sol	OpenAI	16.54	9	0.211	0.536	100.0%	—

Model	Organization	Avg abs-elasticity rank (1=highest)	Avg predictive-uncertainty rank (1=narrowest)	Mean absolute pooled center	Mean pooled 90% width	Success rate	Cost / successful run
DeepSeek V4 Pro	DeepSeek	17.88	15.83	0.2	0.66	100.0%	—
GPT-5.4	OpenAI	20.33	5.75	0.18	0.484	100.0%	\$0.0036
MiniMax M3	MiniMax	21.04	13.75	0.173	0.657	100.0%	—
GPT-5.5	OpenAI	21.96	9.42	0.17	0.54	100.0%	\$0.0137
Gemini 3 Flash	Google	22.75	6.5	0.163	0.503	100.0%	\$0.0010
Gemini 3.5 Flash	Google	22.83	3.25	0.165	0.446	100.0%	\$0.0100
Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite	Google	24.17	4.75	0.13	0.456	100.0%	\$0.0008

Appendix Table A11. Simulation-facing disagreement.

Note: Simulation-facing PolicyEngine substitution-response coefficients only, sorted by cross-model spread in pooled point estimates.

Quantity	Lowest model	Lowest center	Highest model	Highest center	Spread	Mean pooled 90% width	Spread / mean width
Primary-earner substitution elasticity in a tax-benefit simulation, decile 7	Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite	0.086	GPT-5.4 nano	0.623	0.537	0.607	0.885

Quantity	Lowest model	Lowest center	Highest model	Highest center	Spread	Mean pooled 90% width	Spread / mean width
Primary- earner substitu- tion elasticity in a tax- benefit simula- tion, decile 8	Gemini 3.1 Flash- Lite	0.11	GPT-5.4 nano	0.609	0.499	0.621	0.803
Primary- earner substitu- tion elasticity in a tax- benefit simula- tion, decile 6	MiniMax M3	0.114	GPT-5.4 nano	0.59	0.476	0.597	0.797
Primary- earner substitu- tion elasticity in a tax- benefit simula- tion, decile 5	Gemini 3 Flash	0.121	GPT-5.4 nano	0.593	0.473	0.618	0.764

Quantity	Lowest model	Lowest center	Highest model	Highest center	Spread	Mean pooled 90% width	Spread / mean width
Primary- earner substitu- tion elasticity in a tax- benefit simula- tion, decile 10	Gemini 3.5 Flash	0.14	GPT-5.4 nano	0.603	0.463	0.662	0.7
Primary- earner substitu- tion elasticity in a tax- benefit simula- tion, decile 9	Gemini 3.1 Flash- Lite	0.129	GPT-5.4 nano	0.587	0.458	0.646	0.709
Primary- earner substitu- tion elasticity in a tax- benefit simula- tion, decile 3	Gemini 3.1 Flash- Lite	0.069	GPT-5.4 nano	0.52	0.451	0.604	0.748

Quantity	Lowest model	Lowest center	Highest model	Highest center	Spread	Mean pooled 90% width	Spread / mean width
Secondary- earner substitu- tion elasticity in a tax- benefit simula- tion	GPT-5.6 Sol	0.284	Qwen 3.7 Max	0.701	0.417	1.02	0.409
Primary- earner substitu- tion elasticity in a tax- benefit simula- tion, decile 4	Gemini 3.1 Flash- Lite	0.073	GPT-5.4 nano	0.465	0.391	0.602	0.65
Primary- earner substitu- tion elasticity in a tax- benefit simula- tion, decile 2	MiniMax M3	0.069	GPT-5.4 nano	0.376	0.307	0.611	0.503

Quantity	Lowest model	Lowest center	Highest model	Highest center	Spread	Mean pooled 90% width	Spread / mean width
Primary- earner substitu- tion elasticity in a tax- benefit simula- tion, decile 1	Gemini 3.1 Flash- Lite	0.05	GPT-5.4 nano	0.343	0.293	0.634	0.462
Substitu- tion elasticity of labor supply in a tax- benefit simula- tion	Gemini 3.1 Flash- Lite	0.153	GPT-5.6 Terra	0.31	0.157	0.719	0.218

9.1 Static flat-tax plus demogrant frontier

Appendix Table A12 reports a static blank-slate flat-tax benchmark on the same Enhanced CPS 2024 microdata ([PolicyEngine Team 2024](#)). Each row applies a flat tax to PolicyEngine’s current positive-AGI base and rebates the resulting revenue as an equal per-person demogrant using tax-unit size. This is the modernized analogue of a blank-slate UBI-style exercise in the current PolicyEngine stack.

This is a pure distributional comparison, not an optimal-tax result: the benchmark holds behavior fixed and omits leisure. Mean per-person resources are mechanically constant across rows, so the informative objects are the demogrant, the distributional quantiles, and the Gini of per-person post-tax positive-AGI resources.

Appendix Table A12. Static flat positive-AGI tax plus demogrant frontier.

Note: Static PolicyEngine benchmark on Enhanced CPS 2024 microdata. Each row applies a flat tax to the current positive-AGI base and rebates the revenue as an equal per-person

demogrant using tax-unit size. This is a distributional frontier, not a behavioral or leisure-adjusted optimal-tax exercise. Mean per-person resources are mechanically constant across rows, so the informative objects are the demogrant, the distributional quantiles, and the Gini of per-person post-tax positive-AGI resources.

Flat tax rate	Demogrant per person	P10 post-tax resources	Median post-tax resources	P90 post-tax resources	Gini
0%	\$0	\$1,554	\$24,091	\$85,300	0.627
20%	\$8,881	\$10,125	\$28,154	\$77,121	0.501
40%	\$17,763	\$18,695	\$32,217	\$68,942	0.376
60%	\$26,644	\$27,266	\$36,280	\$60,764	0.251
80%	\$35,525	\$35,836	\$40,343	\$52,585	0.125
95%	\$42,186	\$42,264	\$43,391	\$46,451	0.031

9.2 Top-rate robustness to Pareto tail and CRRA curvature

Appendix Table A13 reports the top-rate mapping from Table 4 under alternative values of the Pareto tail parameter a and the CRRA curvature γ . The column-wise comparison asks how the implied optimal top rate moves when the microdata-calibrated $a = 1.621$ becomes a Pareto tail at 1.3, 1.5, or 1.7, or when log utility becomes CRRA at $\gamma = 2$ with a held at the microdata estimate. The ETI median feeding each row is the same pooled-mixture median used in Table 4, so column-wise differences reflect only the formula's (a, γ) pair, not any change in the elicited responses. Across all parameterizations, the cross-model ordering never changes.

Appendix Table A13. Top-rate robustness to Pareto tail and CRRA curvature.

Note: Robustness of the utilitarian optimal top-rate mapping in Table 4 to the Pareto tail parameter a and the CRRA coefficient γ . Each cell is the median implied optimal top rate $\tau^* = (1 - \bar{g}) / (1 - \bar{g} + a e)$ computed at the model's pooled ETI median under the (a, γ) pair in the column header, where $\bar{g} = a / (a + \gamma)$. The baseline column ($a = 1.621$, $\gamma = 1$) reproduces the median column in Table 4. The $a = 1.3 / 1.5 / 1.7$ columns vary only the Pareto tail while keeping log utility ($\gamma = 1$); the final column replaces log utility with CRRA at $\gamma = 2$ while holding a at the baseline value above. Under log utility the corresponding welfare weights $\bar{g}$ are $1.3/2.3 = 0.565$, $1.621/(1 + 1.621) = 0.618$, $1.5/2.5 = 0.600$, and $1.7/2.7 = 0.630$; under $\gamma = 2$ with $a = 1.621$, $\bar{g} = 1.621/(1.621 + 2) = 0.448$.

Model	ETI median	Baseline top rate (a=1.621, gamma=1)	Top rate (a=1.3, gamma=1)	Top rate (a=1.5, gamma=1)	Top rate (a=1.7, gamma=1)	Top rate (a=1.621, gamma=2)
Gemini 3.1 Pro	0.351	40.2%	48.8%	43.2%	38.3%	49.3%
Gemini 3.5 Flash	0.357	39.8%	48.4%	42.8%	37.9%	48.9%
GPT-5.5	0.369	39.0%	47.6%	42.0%	37.1%	48.0%
GPT-5.6	0.377	38.4%	47.0%	41.4%	36.6%	47.5%
Luna						
Claude Opus 4.8	0.383	38.0%	46.6%	41.0%	36.2%	47.1%
Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite	0.389	37.7%	46.2%	40.7%	35.9%	46.7%
Claude Opus 4.7	0.4	37.0%	45.5%	40.0%	35.3%	46.0%
Gemini 3 Flash	0.4	37.0%	45.5%	40.0%	35.3%	46.0%
Grok 4.1 Fast	0.4	37.0%	45.5%	40.0%	35.3%	46.0%
Grok 4.5	0.41	36.5%	44.9%	39.4%	34.7%	45.4%
GPT-5.4	0.42	35.9%	44.3%	38.8%	34.2%	44.8%
GPT-5.6	0.431	35.3%	43.7%	38.2%	33.6%	44.2%
Sol						
Claude Fable 5	0.437	35.0%	43.4%	37.9%	33.3%	43.8%
GPT-5.4 mini	0.437	35.0%	43.4%	37.9%	33.3%	43.8%
Grok 4.3	0.439	34.9%	43.3%	37.8%	33.2%	43.7%
MiniMax M3	0.438	34.9%	43.3%	37.8%	33.2%	43.7%
Claude Sonnet 5	0.471	33.3%	41.5%	36.1%	31.6%	42.0%
DeepSeek V4 Pro	0.479	32.9%	41.1%	35.8%	31.3%	41.6%
GPT-5.6 Terra	0.492	32.4%	40.5%	35.2%	30.7%	40.9%
GLM-5.2	0.495	32.2%	40.3%	35.0%	30.6%	40.8%
Kimi K2.6	0.499	32.1%	40.1%	34.8%	30.4%	40.6%
Claude Sonnet 4.6	0.5	32.0%	40.1%	34.8%	30.3%	40.5%

Model	ETI median	Baseline top rate (a=1.621, gamma=1)	Top rate (a=1.3, gamma=1)	Top rate (a=1.5, gamma=1)	Top rate (a=1.7, gamma=1)	Top rate (a=1.621, gamma=2)
Grok 4.20	0.5	32.0%	40.1%	34.8%	30.3%	40.5%
Claude	0.502	31.9%	40.0%	34.7%	30.3%	40.4%
Haiku 4.5						
GPT-5.4	0.546	30.1%	38.0%	32.8%	28.5%	38.4%
nano						
Qwen 3.7	0.555	29.8%	37.6%	32.4%	28.2%	38.0%
Max						

9.3 Resampling standard errors and rank stability

Appendix Table A14 resamples the 15 runs within each canonical cell (200 bootstrap resamples, fixed seed) to attach Monte Carlo standard errors to the pooled center and pooled 90 percent width, and to test whether the predictive-uncertainty ordering survives run-level resampling. Median center standard errors are small in absolute terms for every model, relative width standard errors run 1 to 8 percent, and each model’s average width rank carries a narrow 90 percent resampling interval. The width ordering reported in the main text is therefore signal, not $R = 15$ noise. This diagnostic covers the canonical-panel width ordering; the subpanel top-three and bottom-three callouts in Tables 1-2 average over fewer quantities and carry correspondingly wider resampling bands, so read them as coarse groupings, not exact placements.

Appendix Table A14. Monte Carlo resampling of pooled summaries.

Note: Monte Carlo uncertainty in the pooled summaries from resampling the 15 runs within each canonical cell (200 bootstrap resamples, fixed seed). Center MC SE is the standard error of the pooled center; relative width MC SE is the standard error of the pooled 90% width divided by its mean. The final columns show the distribution of each model’s average width rank across resamples; narrow intervals indicate the predictive-uncertainty ordering is stable to run-level resampling at $R = 15$.

Model	Median center MC SE	Median relative width MC SE	Avg width rank (mean)	Avg width rank 90% interval
Claude Fable 5	0.003	3%	6.22	[5.54, 6.85]
Claude Haiku	0.005	5%	7.7	[6.92, 8.38]
4.5				
Claude Opus 4.7	0	2%	8.28	[7.54, 9.00]
Claude Sonnet 5	0.002	2%	8.39	[7.77, 9.08]
Gemini 3.1 Pro	0.007	2%	9.01	[8.38, 9.54]

Model	Median center MC SE	Median relative width MC SE	Avg width rank (mean)	Avg width rank 90% interval
Claude Opus 4.8	0	1%	9.48	[8.85, 10.08]
Gemini 3 Flash	0	1%	10.7	[10.08, 11.23]
Gemini 3.5 Flash	0.01	3%	11.2	[10.69, 11.77]
GPT-5.6 Terra	0.003	3%	11.41	[10.53, 12.31]
Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite	0.006	5%	11.68	[10.69, 12.46]
Claude Sonnet 4.6	0	1%	11.71	[10.92, 12.39]
GPT-5.5	0.005	2%	12.71	[12.30, 13.15]
GPT-5.4	0	3%	12.83	[12.15, 13.54]
GPT-5.6 Sol	0.008	3%	14.48	[13.85, 15.08]
MiniMax M3	0.017	8%	15.24	[13.92, 16.47]
Grok 4.5	0.009	3%	15.4	[14.54, 16.31]
Grok 4.1 Fast	0	2%	15.49	[14.00, 16.77]
Grok 4.3	0.012	5%	15.69	[14.92, 16.54]
GPT-5.4 nano	0.026	6%	15.84	[15.23, 16.38]
Qwen 3.7 Max	0.013	8%	16.12	[14.77, 17.38]
DeepSeek V4 Pro	0.015	7%	16.25	[15.15, 17.23]
GLM-5.2	0.017	7%	16.33	[15.07, 17.46]
Kimi K2.6	0.026	4%	17.91	[16.54, 19.00]
GPT-5.4 mini	0.009	4%	19.29	[18.46, 20.00]
Grok 4.20	0.011	5%	19.86	[19.15, 20.62]
GPT-5.6 Luna	0.012	4%	21.78	[21.07, 22.38]

9.4 Within-run versus between-run variance

Appendix Table A15 splits pooled predictive variance into its two components: the within-run term (the model’s own stated p05-p95 quantiles) and the between-run term (variation of run means across repeated draws). The between-run share is a median of 0 to 2 percent for every model, so what the models state dominates both the pooled widths and the predictive-uncertainty ranking built on them; sampling noise contributes little. The maximum single-cell shares are larger — 37% for minimax-m3, 29% for gpt-5.4-nano, and 25% for gemini-3.5-flash, concentrated in sign-unstable cells — so the median, not the maximum, characterizes the typical cell. This also bounds the concern that the three no-sampling-parameter Claude models rank under a different draw regime: the component their regime affects is a negligible share of the total for every model in the panel. (The between-run term uses the population variance over the 15 run means, a mild downward bias that is immaterial given these shares; the headline interval is the nonparametric mixture, not a Gaussian built from the summed variance.)

Appendix Table A15. Variance decomposition of pooled predictive spread.

Note: Split of the pooled predictive variance over the canonical 13-quantity subpanel into the within-run component (the model’s own stated p05-p95 quantiles) and the between-run component (variation of run means across the 15 repeated draws). The between-run share is the only component affected by the sampling regime, which differs for the three no-sampling-parameter Claude models.

Model	Cells	Median within-run SD	Median between-run SD	Median between-run variance share	Max between-run variance share
Claude Fable 5	13	0.679	0.012	0%	1%
Claude Haiku 4.5	13	0.672	0.018	0%	4%
Claude Opus 4.7	13	0.704	0	0%	0%
Claude Opus 4.8	13	0.72	0	0%	1%
Claude Sonnet 4.6	13	0.726	0	0%	1%
Claude Sonnet 5	13	0.699	0.01	0%	1%
DeepSeek V4 Pro	13	0.738	0.054	1%	4%
GLM-5.2	13	0.683	0.06	1%	13%
GPT-5.4	13	0.684	0	0%	1%
GPT-5.4 mini	13	0.713	0.034	1%	5%
GPT-5.4 nano	13	0.699	0.098	2%	29%
GPT-5.5	13	0.703	0.018	0%	1%
GPT-5.6	13	0.727	0.051	0%	5%
Luna					
GPT-5.6 Sol	13	0.692	0.036	0%	1%
GPT-5.6	13	0.678	0.014	0%	2%
Terra					
Gemini 3 Flash	13	0.677	0	0%	1%
Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite	13	0.687	0.025	0%	3%

Model	Cells	Median within-run SD	Median between-run SD	Median between-run variance share	Max between-run variance share
Gemini 3.1 Pro	13	0.689	0.025	0%	3%
Gemini 3.5 Flash	13	0.683	0.041	0%	25%
Grok 4.1 Fast	13	0.743	0	0%	4%
Grok 4.20	13	0.706	0.042	0%	7%
Grok 4.3	13	0.68	0.046	0%	6%
Grok 4.5	13	0.697	0.034	0%	4%
Kimi K2.6	13	0.701	0.1	1%	6%
MiniMax M3	13	0.692	0.062	1%	37%
Qwen 3.7 Max	13	0.728	0.048	0%	18%

9.5 Harness disclosure

Appendix Table A16 reports the full generation-harness configuration per model. The prompt text and repeated-run design are identical across models; the structured-output mechanism, completion budget, sampling regime, and reasoning configuration follow each provider’s API surface and are therefore confounded with model identity. Completion budgets are truncation guards, not elicitation content — reasoning tokens count against them on models that reason, so I raised budgets where required to avoid truncation. One further asymmetry: the OpenAI path wraps the elicitation prompt with a one-line system message (“Follow the user’s instructions exactly and return only the final answer.”), while the Anthropic and LiteLLM paths send the prompt as a bare user message; the instruction is format-only and the OpenAI request builder attaches it unconditionally (the committed request logs record usage metadata, not message payloads, so the string is checkable in `llm_econ_beliefs/providers.py`).

Appendix Table A16. Per-model generation-harness configuration.

Note: Per-model generation-harness configuration. The prompt text and repeated-run design are identical across models; the structured-output mechanism, completion budget, sampling regime, and reasoning configuration follow each provider’s API surface and are therefore confounded with model identity. Completion budgets are truncation guards: reasoning tokens count against them on models that reason, so budgets were raised where required to avoid truncation. Identifiers marked alias float with provider updates; dated snapshots are pinned.

Model	Provider path	Output mechanism	Completion budget	Sampling	Reasoning config	API identifier	Identifier type
GPT-5.5	OpenAI Chat Completions	strict JSON schema	1200 (8000 for the 40 re-elicited runs)	temperature 1.0, batched n <= 8	provider default effort	gpt-5.5	alias
GPT-5.6 Sol	OpenAI Chat Completions	strict JSON schema	8000	temperature 1.0, batched n <= 8	provider default effort	gpt-5.6-sol	alias
GPT-5.6 Luna	OpenAI Chat Completions	strict JSON schema	8000	temperature 1.0, batched n <= 8	provider default effort	gpt-5.6-luna	alias
GPT-5.6 Terra	OpenAI Chat Completions	strict JSON schema	8000	temperature 1.0, batched n <= 8	provider default effort	gpt-5.6-terra	alias
GPT-5.4	OpenAI Chat Completions	strict JSON schema	1200	temperature 1.0, batched n <= 8	provider default effort	gpt-5.4	alias
GPT-5.4 mini	OpenAI Chat Completions	strict JSON schema	1200	temperature 1.0, batched n <= 8	provider default effort	gpt-5.4-mini	alias
GPT-5.4 nano	OpenAI Chat Completions	strict JSON schema	1200	temperature 1.0, batched n <= 8	provider default effort	gpt-5.4-nano	alias
Claude Fable 5	native Anthropic API	strict JSON schema	32000	none accepted (provider default)	always-on reasoning	claude-fable-5	alias
Claude Opus 4.8	native Anthropic API	strict JSON schema	32000	none accepted (provider default)	off (provider default)	claude-opus-4-8	alias

Model	Provider path	Output mechanism	Completion budget	Sampling	Reasoning config	API identifier	Identifier type
Claude Sonnet 5	native Anthropic API	strict JSON schema	32000	none accepted (provider default)	adaptive (provider default)	claude-sonnet-5	alias
Claude Opus 4.7	LiteLLM	forced function call	1200	temperature 1.0	off (provider default)	claude-opus-4-7	alias
Claude Sonnet 4.6	LiteLLM	forced function call	1200	temperature 1.0	off (provider default)	claude-sonnet-4-6	alias
Claude Haiku 4.5	LiteLLM	forced function call	1200	temperature 1.0	off (provider default)	claude-haiku-4-5-20251001	dated snapshot
Gemini 3.1 Pro	LiteLLM	forced JSON object	1200	temperature 1.0	provider default thinking	gemini-3.1-pro-preview	preview alias
Gemini 3.5 Flash	LiteLLM	forced JSON object	4000	temperature 1.0	provider default thinking	gemini-3.5-flash	alias
Gemini 3 Flash	LiteLLM	forced JSON object	1200	temperature 1.0	provider default thinking	gemini-3-flash-preview	preview alias
Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite	LiteLLM	forced JSON object	1200	temperature 1.0	provider default thinking	gemini-3.1-flash-lite-preview	preview alias
Grok 4.20	LiteLLM	forced function call	1200	temperature 1.0	reasoning variant	xai/grok-4.20-reasoning	alias
Grok 4.3	LiteLLM	forced function call	4000	temperature 1.0	provider default	xai/grok-4.3	alias
Grok 4.5	LiteLLM	forced function call	8000	temperature 1.0	provider default	xai/grok-4.5	alias

Model	Provider path	Output mechanism	Completion budget	Sampling	Reasoning config	API identifier	Identifier type
DeepSeek V4 Pro	LiteLLM via Open-Router	forced JSON object (schema validated locally)	8000	temperature 1.0	provider default	open-router/deepseek/deepseek-v4-pro	alias
Qwen 3.7 Max	LiteLLM via Open-Router	forced JSON object (schema validated locally)	8000	temperature 1.0	provider default	open-router/qwen/qwen3.7-max	alias
Kimi K2.6	LiteLLM via Open-Router	forced JSON object (schema validated locally)	8000	temperature 1.0	provider default	open-router/moonshotai/kimi-k2.6	alias
GLM-5.2	LiteLLM via Open-Router	forced JSON object (schema validated locally)	16000	temperature 1.0	provider default	open-router/zai/glm-5.2	alias
MiniMax M3	LiteLLM via Open-Router	forced JSON object (schema validated locally)	8000	temperature 1.0	provider default	open-router/minimax/minimax-m3	alias
Grok 4.1 Fast	LiteLLM	forced function call	1200	temperature 1.0	non-reasoning variant	xai/grok-4-1-fast-non-reasoning	alias

9.6 Cross-mechanism ablation

Appendix Table A17 addresses the mechanism confound directly by re-eliciting Claude Opus 4.7 — an April model originally run through the LiteLLM forced-function-call path at a 1,200-token budget — through the July native strict-JSON-schema path at a 32,000-token budget, on the nine canonical elasticities with 15 fresh runs each. Pooled centers move by at most 0.03 (median 0.00); pooled widths move more, from -15 to +7 percent across the nine quantities with no consistent direction. Within the panel’s resolution, the harness mechanism does not move elicited centers, which supports reading cross-wave differences in centers as model differences; width comparisons across waves carry the extra mechanism noise. The ablation isolates the output mechanism and completion budget only — Claude Opus 4.7 runs without extended reasoning on both paths, so the July models’ always-on or adaptive reasoning modes remain confounded with model identity.

Appendix Table A17. Same model, two harness mechanisms.

Note: Same model (Claude Opus 4.7), same v4 prompts, same repeated-run design, two harness mechanisms: the April LiteLLM forced-function-call path (temperature 1.0, 1200-token budget) versus the July native Anthropic strict-JSON-schema path (no sampling parameters, 32000-token budget). Each cell pools 15 fresh runs elicited in July 2026 under the native mechanism against the April panel cell. Centers are stable (max absolute change 0.03); widths move from -15 to +7 percent across quantities with no consistent direction. Opus 4.7 runs without extended reasoning on both paths, so the reasoning-mode axis is not covered.

Quantity	LiteLLM center	Native center	Center change	LiteLLM 90% width	Native 90% width
Armington elasticity	1.533	1.533	0	3.895	4.057
Capital gains realizations elasticity	-0.7	-0.7	0	1.527	1.63
Elasticity of substitution between capital and labor	0.6	0.6	0	0.903	0.885
Elasticity of taxable income	0.4	0.4	0	0.873	0.892

Quantity	LiteLLM center	Native center	Center change	LiteLLM 90% width	Native 90% width
Employment participation elasticity of single mothers	0.7	0.71	0.01	1.196	1.198
Frisch elasticity of labor supply	0.417	0.387	-0.03	1.318	1.119
Income elasticity of labor supply	-0.05	-0.05	0	0.22	0.22
Intertemporal elasticity of substitution	0.5	0.5	0	1.873	1.698
Uncompensated wage elasticity of labor supply	0.1	0.1	0	0.449	0.4

9.7 Support bounds registry

Appendix Table A18 tabulates the per-quantity support bounds that drive quantile-bin reconstruction, tail extrapolation, and the transforms behind the REML and Bayesian estimators. For unbounded sides, the reconstruction extends the support 0.25 x the adjacent inter-quantile gap beyond the elicited p05/p95; the headline pooled 5-95 interval is largely insensitive to this rule because its endpoints sit at or near the elicited quantile knots, while the SD-based and REML/Bayes summaries are more exposed to it.

Appendix Table A18. Registry support bounds.

Note: Registry support bounds used for quantile-bin reconstruction, tail extrapolation, and the transforms behind the REML and Bayesian estimators. Unbounded sides use a tail-extrapolation rule that extends 0.25 x the adjacent inter-quantile gap beyond the elicited p05/p95.

Quantity	Quantity id	Lower support	Upper support
Annual discount factor	household.annual_discount_factor	0	1

Quantity	Quantity id	Lower support	Upper support
Intertemporal elasticity of substitution	household.intertemporal_elasticity_of_substitution	0	5
Coefficient of relative risk aversion	household.relative_risk_aversion.crra	0	50
Employment participation elasticity of single mothers	labor_supply.extensive_margin.single_mothers	-1	5
Frisch elasticity of labor supply	labor_supply.frisch_elasticity.prime_age	0	10
Income elasticity of labor supply	labor_supply.income_elasticity.prime_age	-2	1
Uncompensated wage elasticity of labor supply	labor_supply.marshallian_wage_elasticity.prime_age	-2	4
Substitution elasticity of labor supply in a tax-benefit simulation	labor_supply.policy_response.substitution_elasticity.all	0	5
Primary-earner substitution elasticity in a tax-benefit simulation, decile 1	labor_supply.policy_response.substitution_elasticity.primary.decile_1	0	5
Primary-earner substitution elasticity in a tax-benefit simulation, decile 10	labor_supply.policy_response.substitution_elasticity.primary.decile_10	0	5
Primary-earner substitution elasticity in a tax-benefit simulation, decile 2	labor_supply.policy_response.substitution_elasticity.primary.decile_2	0	5
Primary-earner substitution elasticity in a tax-benefit simulation, decile 3	labor_supply.policy_response.substitution_elasticity.primary.decile_3	0	5

Quantity	Quantity id	Lower support	Upper support
Primary-earner substitution elasticity in a tax-benefit simulation, decile 4	labor_supply.pol- icy_response.substi- tution_elasticity.pri- mary.decile_4	0	5
Primary-earner substitution elasticity in a tax-benefit simulation, decile 5	labor_supply.pol- icy_response.substi- tution_elasticity.pri- mary.decile_5	0	5
Primary-earner substitution elasticity in a tax-benefit simulation, decile 6	labor_supply.pol- icy_response.substi- tution_elasticity.pri- mary.decile_6	0	5
Primary-earner substitution elasticity in a tax-benefit simulation, decile 7	labor_supply.pol- icy_response.substi- tution_elasticity.pri- mary.decile_7	0	5
Primary-earner substitution elasticity in a tax-benefit simulation, decile 8	labor_supply.pol- icy_response.substi- tution_elasticity.pri- mary.decile_8	0	5
Primary-earner substitution elasticity in a tax-benefit simulation, decile 9	labor_supply.pol- icy_response.substi- tution_elasticity.pri- mary.decile_9	0	5
Secondary-earner substitution elasticity in a tax-benefit simulation	labor_supply.pol- icy_response.substi- tution_elasticity.sec- ondary	0	5
TFP persistence	macro.tfp_persis- tence.ar1	0	1
Elasticity of substitution between capital and labor	production.capi- tal_labor_substitu- tion	0	10
Capital share in production	production.capi- tal_share	0	1
Capital gains realizations elasticity	tax.capital_gains_re- alizations.elasticity	-10	2
Capital gains realizations elasticity (net-of-tax-rate convention)	tax.capital_gains_re- alizations.elastic- ity.net_of_tax_rate	-2	10

Quantity	Quantity id	Lower support	Upper support
Elasticity of taxable income	tax.elasticity_of_taxable_income.top_earners	-1	5
Armington elasticity	trade.armington_elasticity.import_domestic	0	20

10 Statements

Data accessibility. All elicitation code, raw run-level responses, request logs, generated tables, and the scripts that rebuild every table in this paper are public at <https://github.com/PolicyEngine/llm-econ-beliefs>. The cached-results reproduction path rebuilds all paper tables without provider API access; full re-elicitation instructions and tracked costs are in the repository README. A versioned archive with a DOI will be deposited on acceptance.

Author contributions. M.G. designed the study, collected the data, performed the analysis, and wrote the paper.

Competing interests. The author is a co-founder of PolicyEngine, whose tax-benefit microsimulation parameters are among the simulation-facing quantities studied in this paper.

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Ethics. This study involved no human participants or animal subjects; the elicited subjects are commercial language-model APIs.

Use of AI. Language models are the object of study throughout. AI coding assistants helped develop the elicitation harness and draft portions of the manuscript; the author verified all analyses and claims.

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